

Talkie

User & Administrator Manual

Chat, play and work together.

Version 1.0 · October 2026

Blazor WebAssembly · ASP.NET Core · EF Core 10 · SQL Server 2025 · .NET Aspire 13

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1. Welcome to Talkie

Talkie is a chat platform for companies with a playful twist. Colleagues talk in direct messages, group chats and company channels, while a small game layer rewards them with **money** and **shards** that can be spent in the shop on boxes, avatar effects and shard boosters.

This manual explains every screen of the application, for regular members, company owners and the app administrator.

Who is who

Account	What it can do
Member	Chat, use the AI assistant, view the company, report users, view stats, use the shop and go AFK.
Company owner	Everything a member can, plus: add, edit and delete members, manage roles, and create, edit and delete channels on the company server.
admin@talkie.com	The app administrator. Sees the special **pencil button** next to the avatar to configure the whole app, sees all reports and is the only one who can remove reports.

Built-in accounts

Talkie ships with one company, **Talkie**. No other company can use that name. Two accounts are created automatically:

E-mail	Password	Role
owner@talkie.com	fwkh837h@m1	Owner of the Talkie company
admin@talkie.com	TalkieAdmin1! (configurable)	App administrator (pencil button)

> **Security** The admin password comes from the Aspire parameter **admin-password** and is only used when the account is first created. Change it after the first login via **Account > Security**.

Sidebar

After logging in, the sidebar on the left gives access to the seven areas of Talkie:

Area	Purpose
Chat	Direct messages, group chats and your company server with its text channels.
AI assistant	A simple assistant that knows Talkie, your stats and can search your chats.
Company	Members and roles of your company.
Reports	Report users who break the rules.

Area	Purpose
Stats	Money, shards, playtime, chat messages sent and boxes opened.
Shop	Exchange money and shards, buy boxes, avatar effects and shard boosters.
AFK	Go away from keyboard and earn shards every minute.

2. Logging in and creating a company

Login

Open Talkie in your browser. The login screen has two buttons at the top: **Login** and **Create Company**. To log in, type your e-mail and password and press **Login** (or Enter). Click the eye icon to show the password.



Figure 1. The login screen.

Create a company

Choose **Create Company** to register a new company. You will become its owner and are logged in immediately. The form asks for:

- **Company name** - must be unique. **Talkie** is reserved and cannot be used (in any capitalisation).
- **Owner e-mail** - the e-mail address of the owner. It must not be in use yet.
- **Owner password** - at least 8 characters with a letter and a digit.
- **Username** and **Display name** of the owner.
- **Roles** (optional) - click the **+** button to create roles with a name and a color. Click a role chip to edit it, or its **x** to remove it. Roles can be changed later in the Company page.

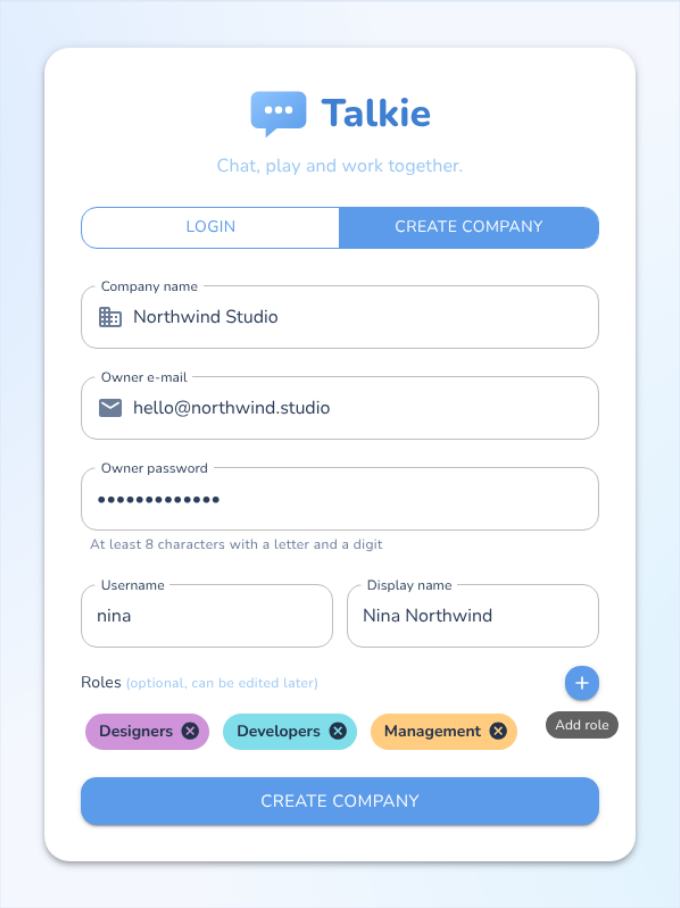


Figure 2. Creating a company with three roles.

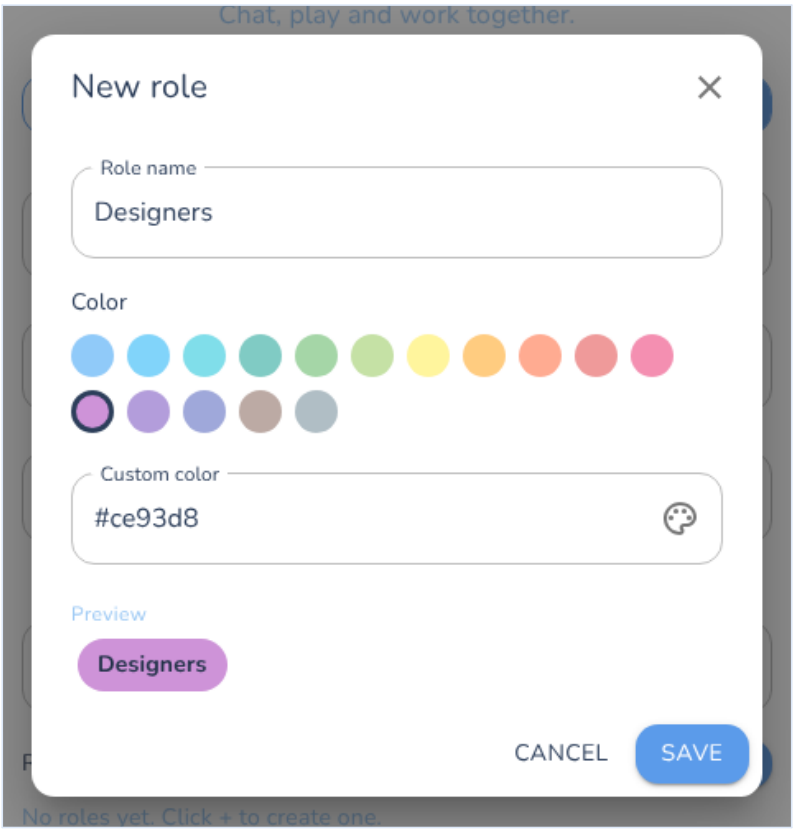


Figure 3. The role dialog: pick a pastel preset or any custom color.

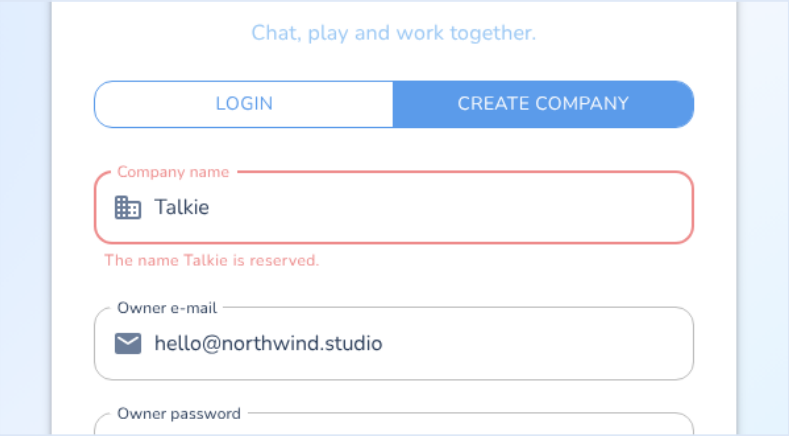


Figure 4. The name Talkie is reserved.

When the company is created Talkie automatically sets up a **server** with the same name as the company, with the channels **#general** and **#random**, and sends a welcome e-mail to the owner.

3. Finding your way around

The top bar shows the Talkie logo, your **money** and **shards** (click them to jump to the shop or AFK) and your avatar. Click your avatar to open a small dropdown with your **name and e-mail**, a link to your **Account** and **Logout**.

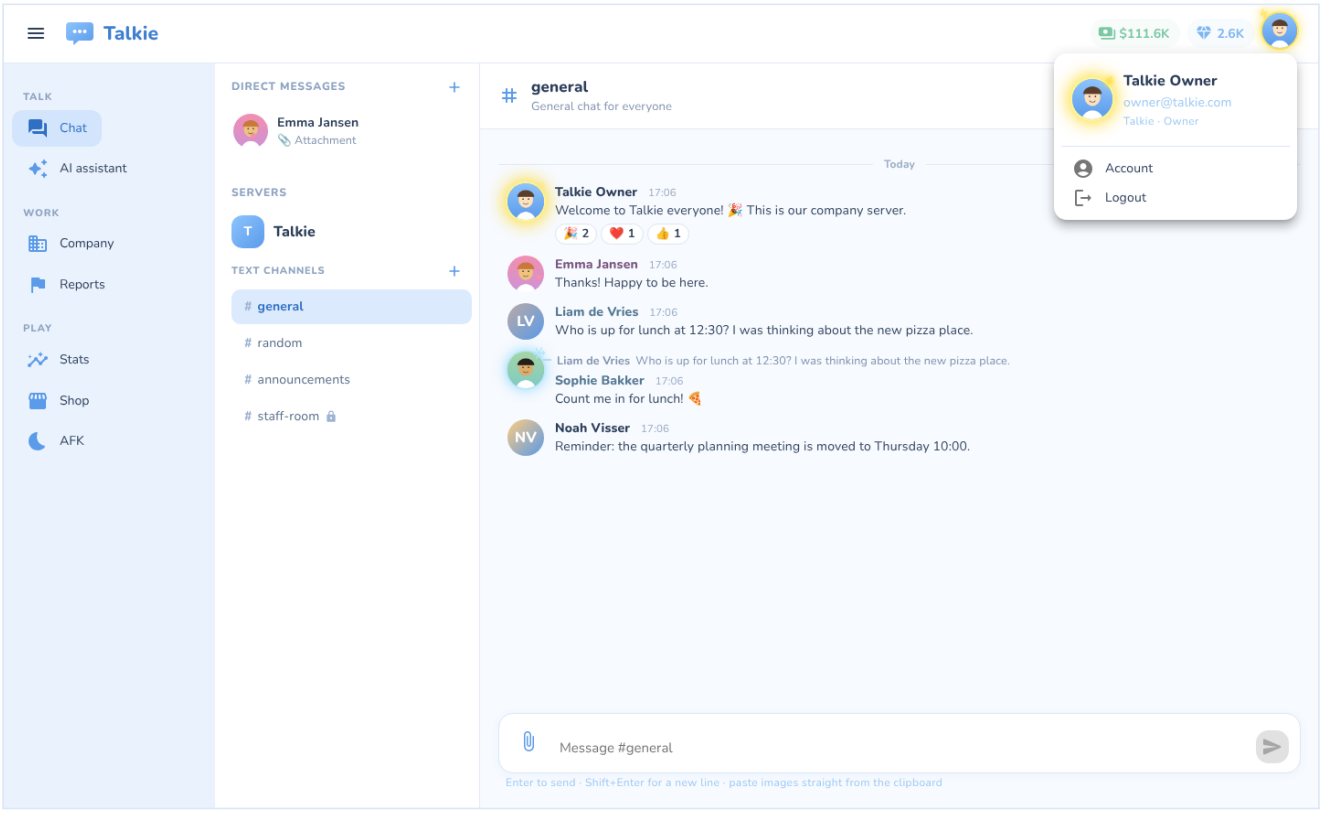


Figure 5. The avatar dropdown with name, e-mail, Account and Logout.

When you are logged in as **admin@talkie.com** there is a special **pencil button** right next to the avatar. It opens the app configuration (see chapter 12).

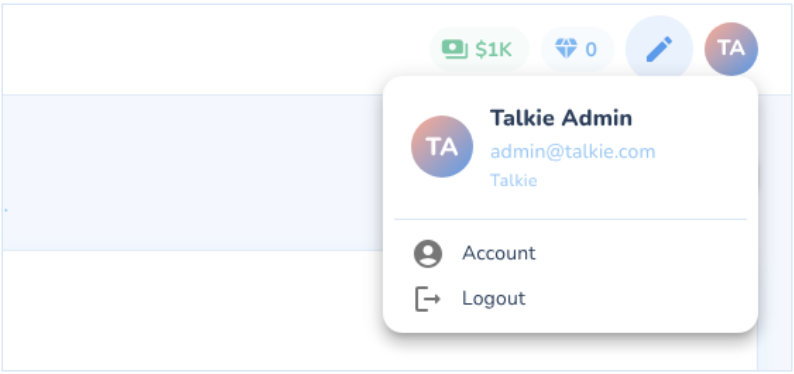


Figure 6. The pencil button is only visible for admin@talkie.com.

Big numbers

Everywhere in Talkie large numbers are shortened: 1,000 = **1K**, 1,000,000 = **1M**, then **1B** (billion), **1T** (trillion) and **1Q** (quadrillion). One decimal is shown when useful, e.g. 1,500 = 1.5K. Hover a number in Stats to see the exact value.

4. Chat

The chat page has two sections in its side panel: **Direct Messages** and **Servers**. The selected conversation or channel is shown on the right.

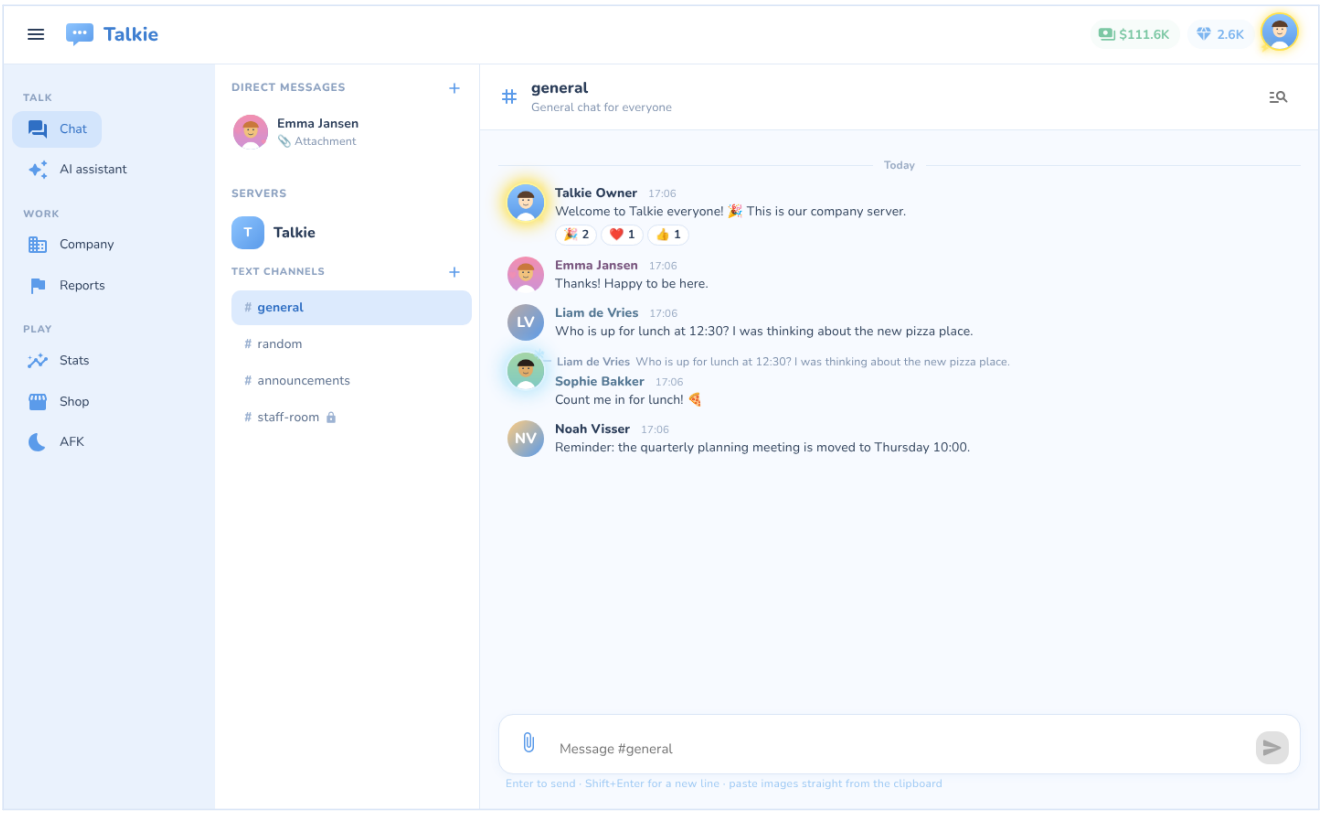


Figure 7. The chat page with the company server and the #general channel.

Direct messages

Click the **+** next to Direct Messages and choose **New message**. Type the e-mail of the person you want to talk to (suggestions appear while typing) and press **Start chat**. You can message anyone on Talkie by e-mail, also people from other companies.

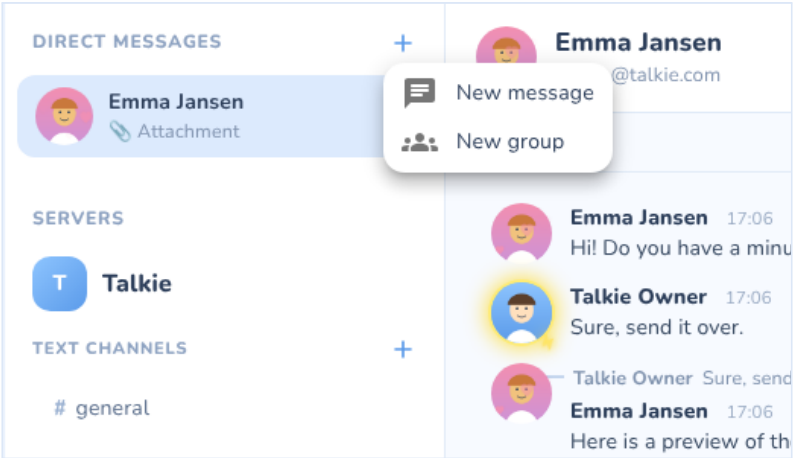


Figure 8. The + menu: start a new message or a new group.

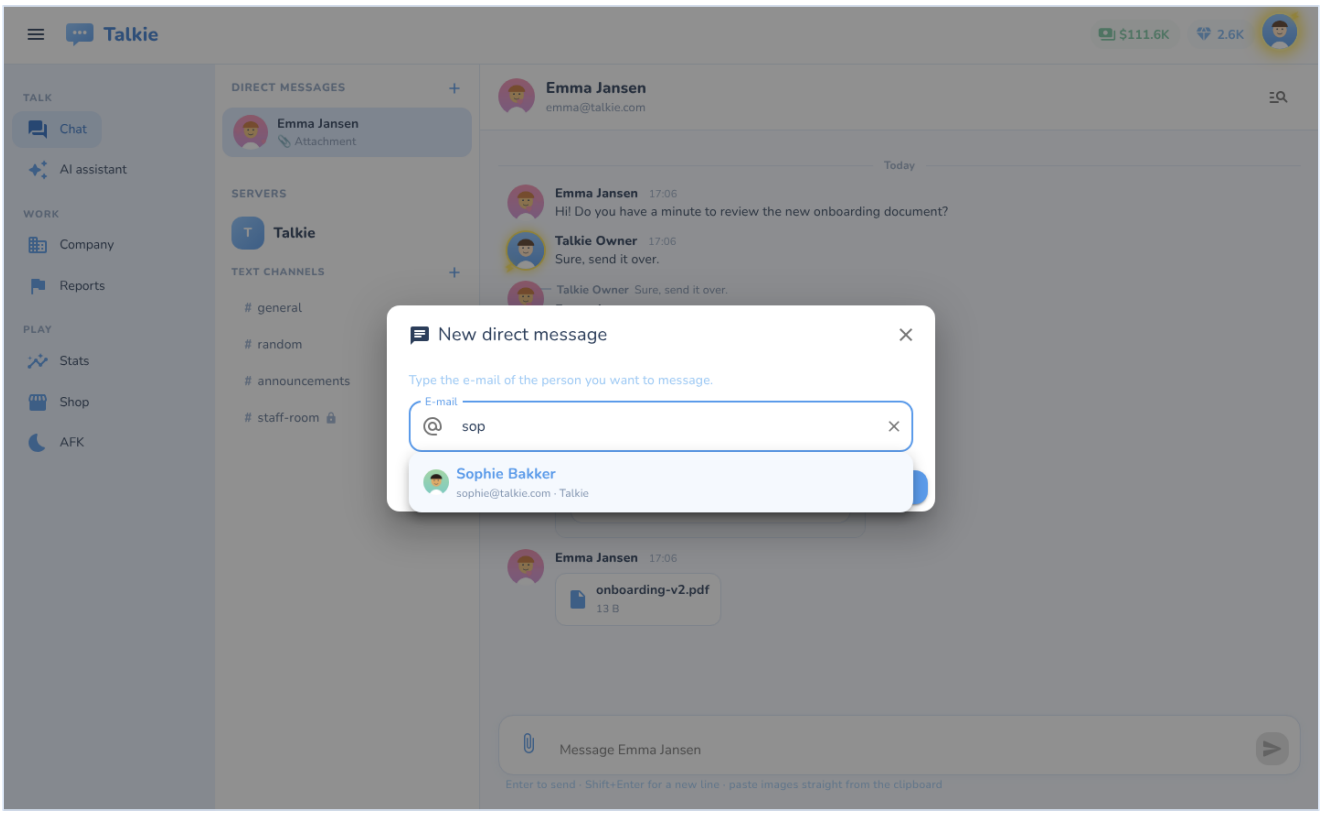


Figure 9. Starting a direct message by e-mail.

Groups

Choose **New group** in the same menu. Give the group a name and add people by e-mail with the add button. You become the **group owner**: the owner can delete any message in the group (other members can only delete their own).

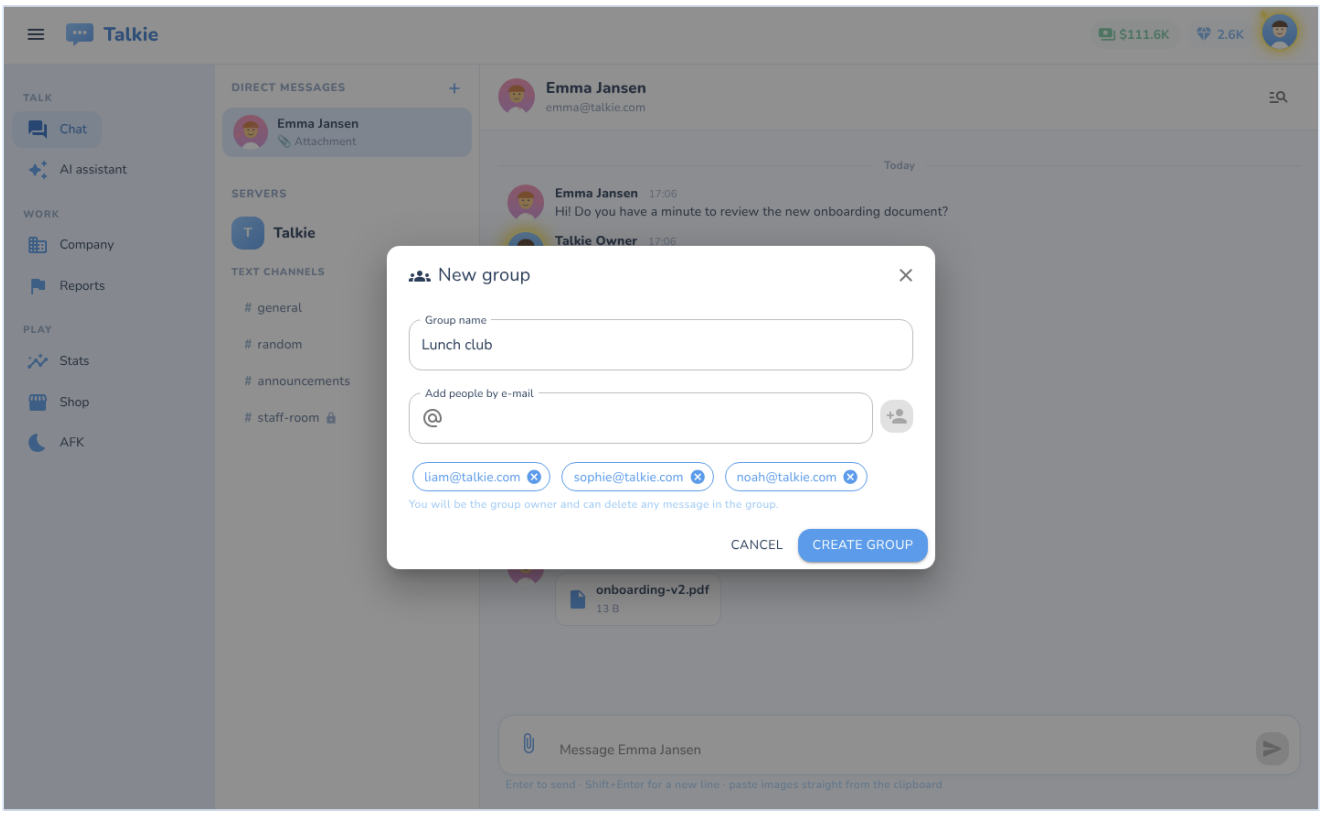


Figure 10. Creating a group with three people.

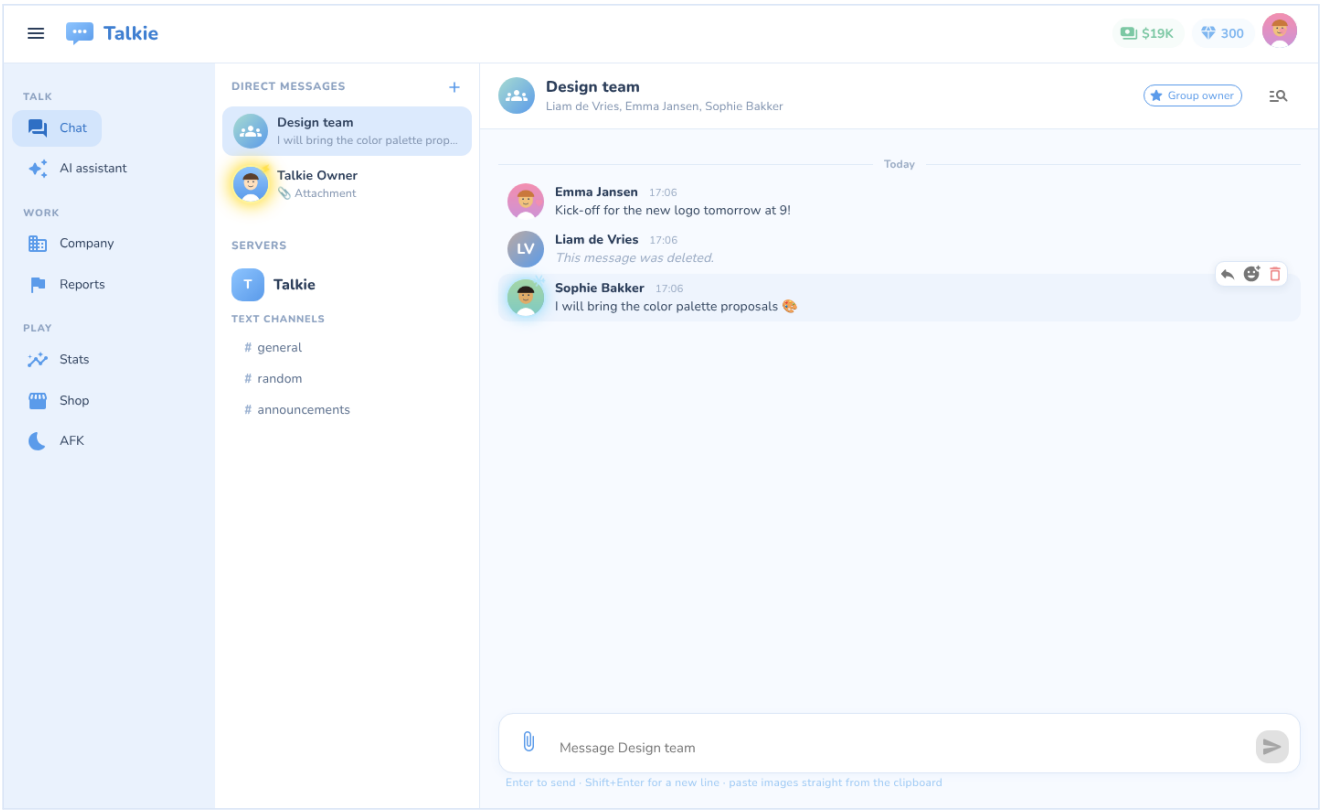


Figure 11. As group owner, the delete action is available on every message in the group.

Writing messages

- Type in the box at the bottom and press **Enter** to send. **Shift+Enter** adds a new line.
- **Attach files** with the paperclip button (up to 10 MB per file).

- **Paste images** straight from the clipboard (Ctrl+V): they are uploaded and previewed before sending.
- Images are shown inline; click one to open it larger. Other files appear as a download card.

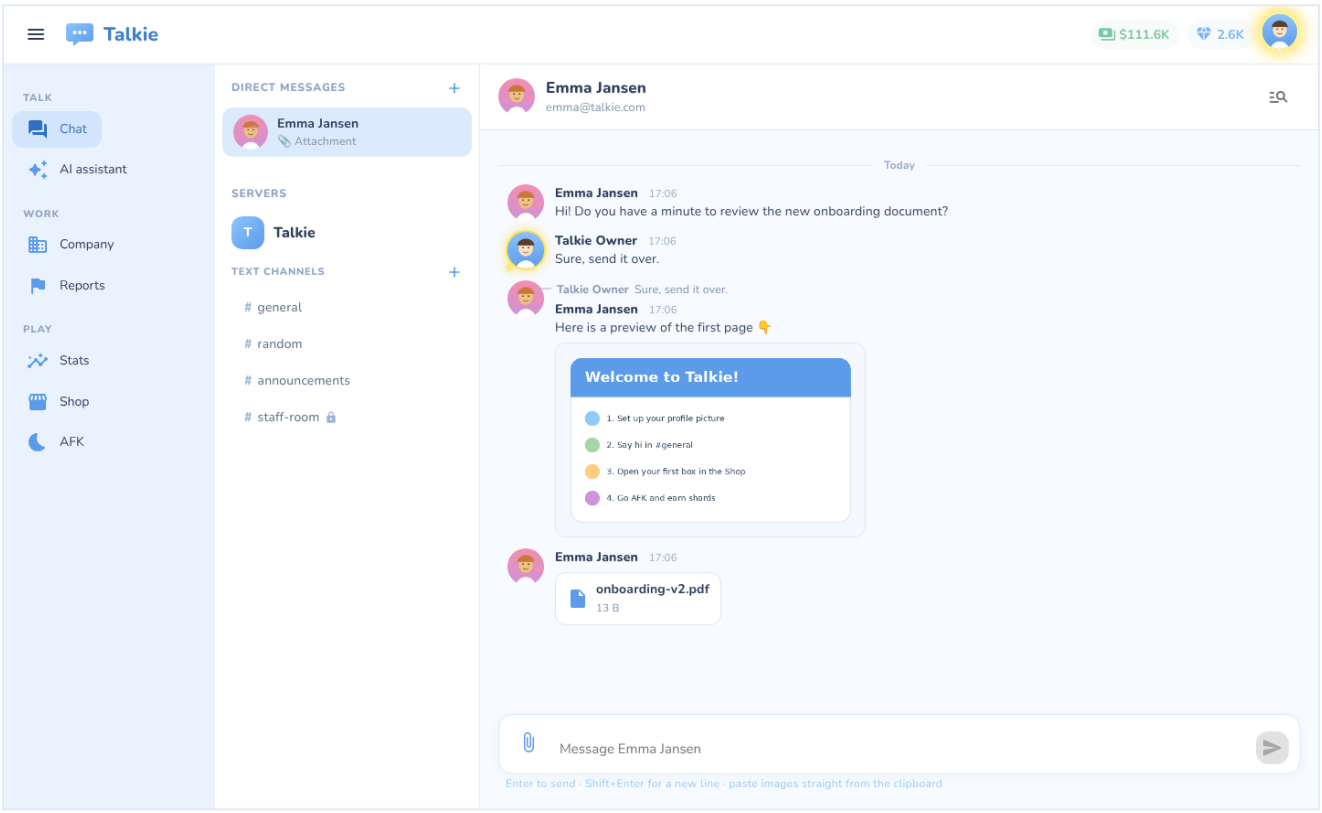


Figure 12. A direct message with a reply, an image and a file attachment.

Replies, reactions and deleting

Hover a message to show its actions: **Reply**, **React** and **Delete**. A reply shows a small preview of the original message above it. Reactions are shown as chips under the message; click a chip to add or remove your reaction.

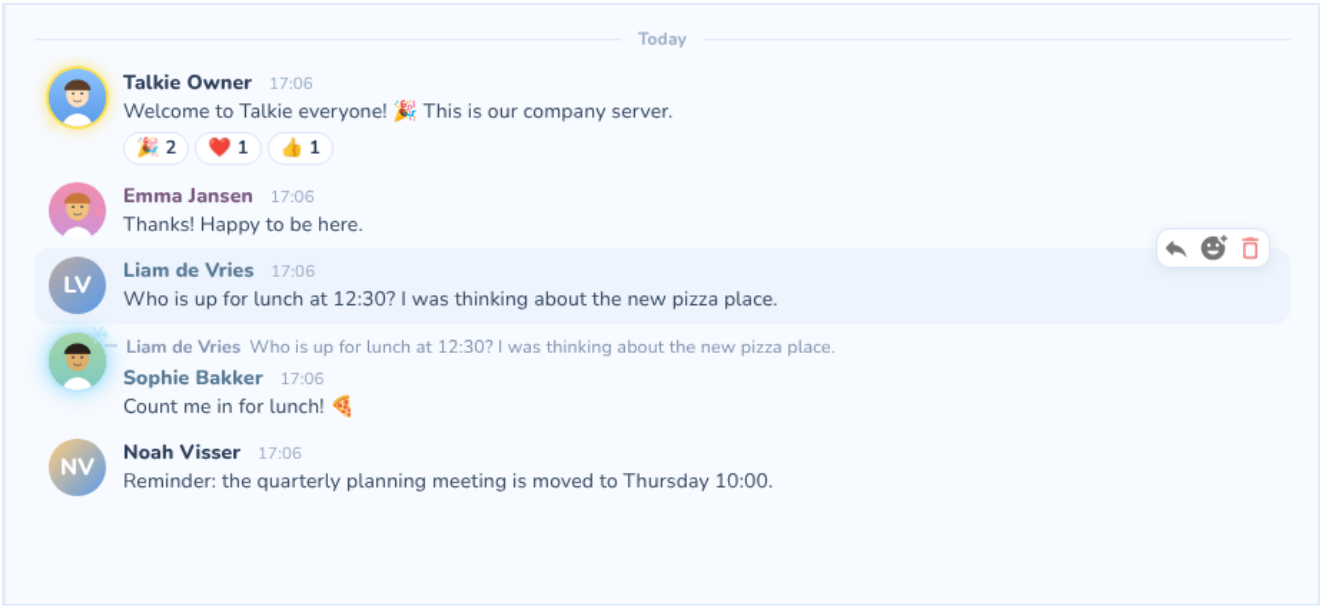


Figure 13. Hovering a message shows reply, react and delete.

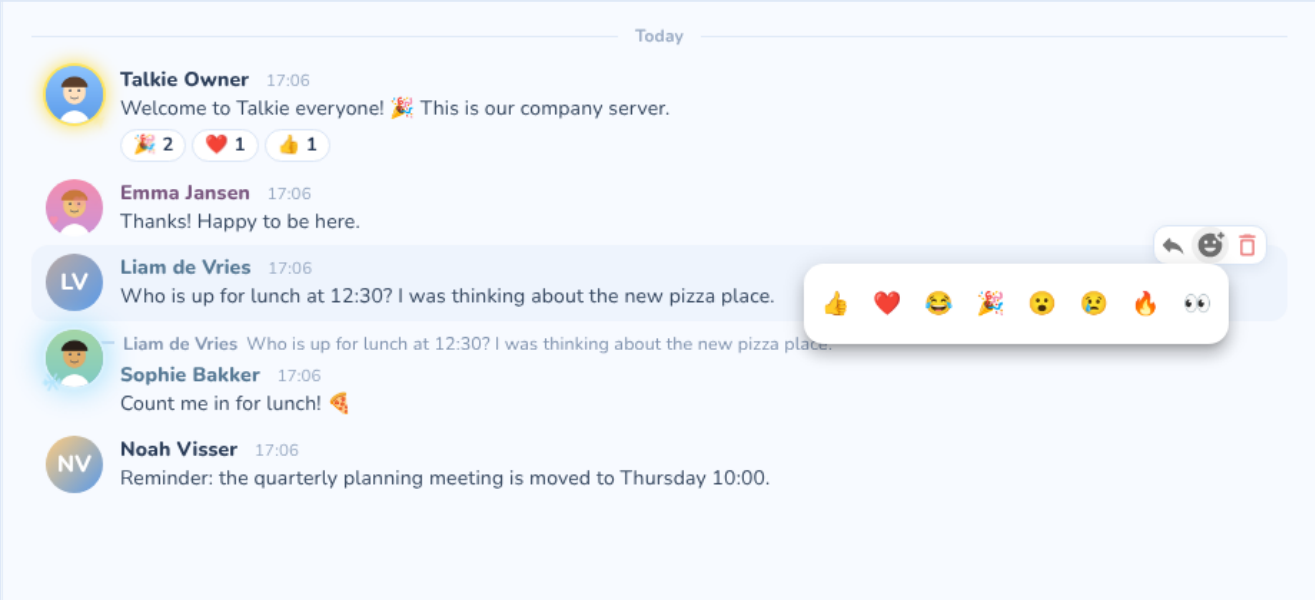


Figure 14. Picking an emoji reaction.

Deleted messages are replaced by "This message was deleted." for everyone. Messages appear for the other people in real time (no refresh needed).

Servers and text channels

Every company has one server, named after the company. Company owners see a **+** next to Text channels to create a channel, and a gear icon on each channel to edit or delete it. A channel has:

- **Name** and **description**.
- **Roles** - the roles that may see the channel. Leave all roles unselected so everyone can see it. Restricted channels show a lock icon. You can create new roles right from the dialog with **New role**; they use the same role list as the company.
- **Permissions** - per role: **Send messages**, **Delete messages** and **React with emoji**. By default **@everyone** can send messages and react with emoji. A member gets a permission when @everyone or any of their roles has it. The company owner can always do everything.

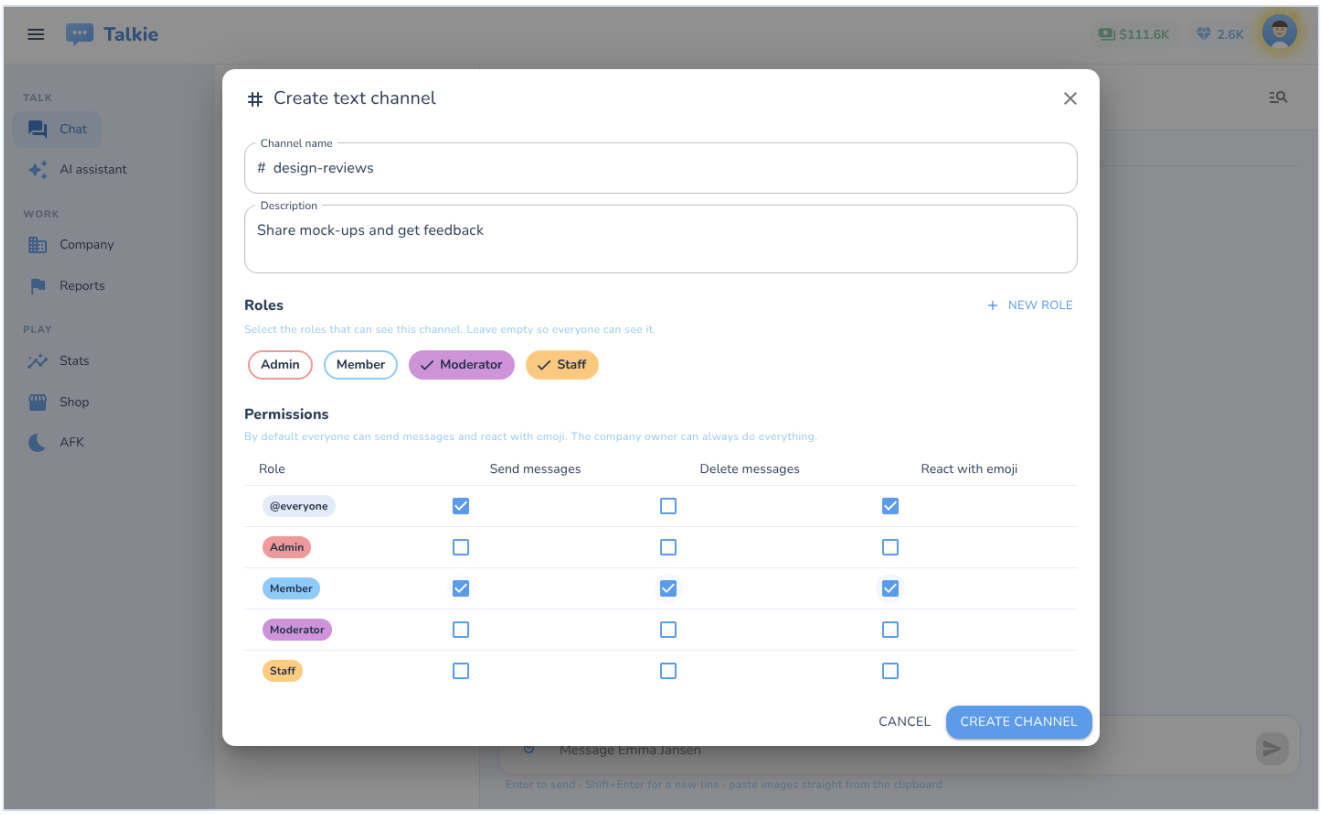


Figure 15. Creating a channel visible to two roles, with extra permissions for Member.

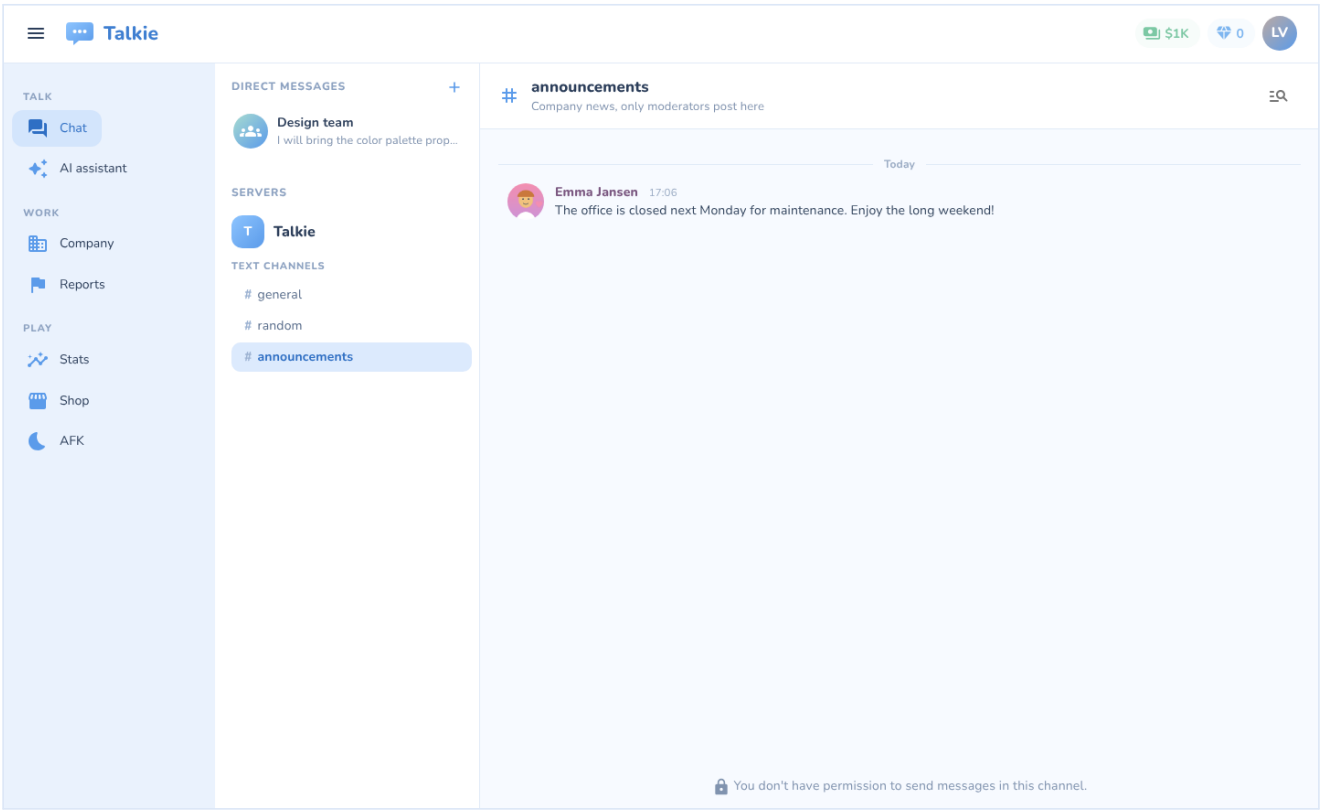


Figure 16. A channel where your roles cannot send messages is read-only.

Searching messages

Click the search icon in the chat header to search every message you can read. Search is **semantic**: messages are stored with an embedding in SQL Server 2025's native **vector** type

and ranked by cosine similarity, so related words match too (e.g. "lunch plans" finds "Who is up for lunch?"). Click a result to jump to that conversation.

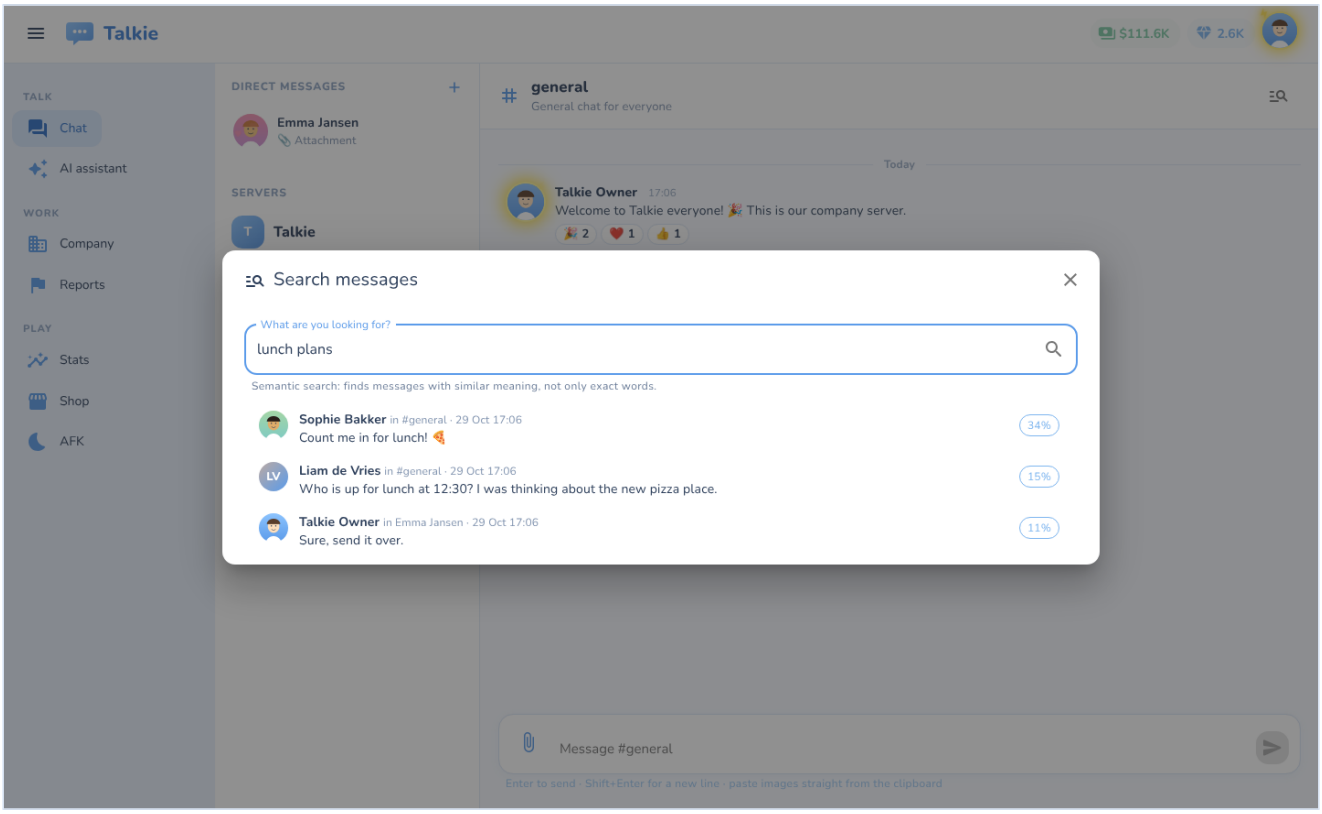


Figure 17. Semantic message search with similarity scores.

5. AI assistant

The AI assistant is a simple helper. Ask it how a feature works, ask for **"my stats"**, or say **"search"** followed by a topic to find chat messages. The conversation is saved; use **Clear chat** to start over.

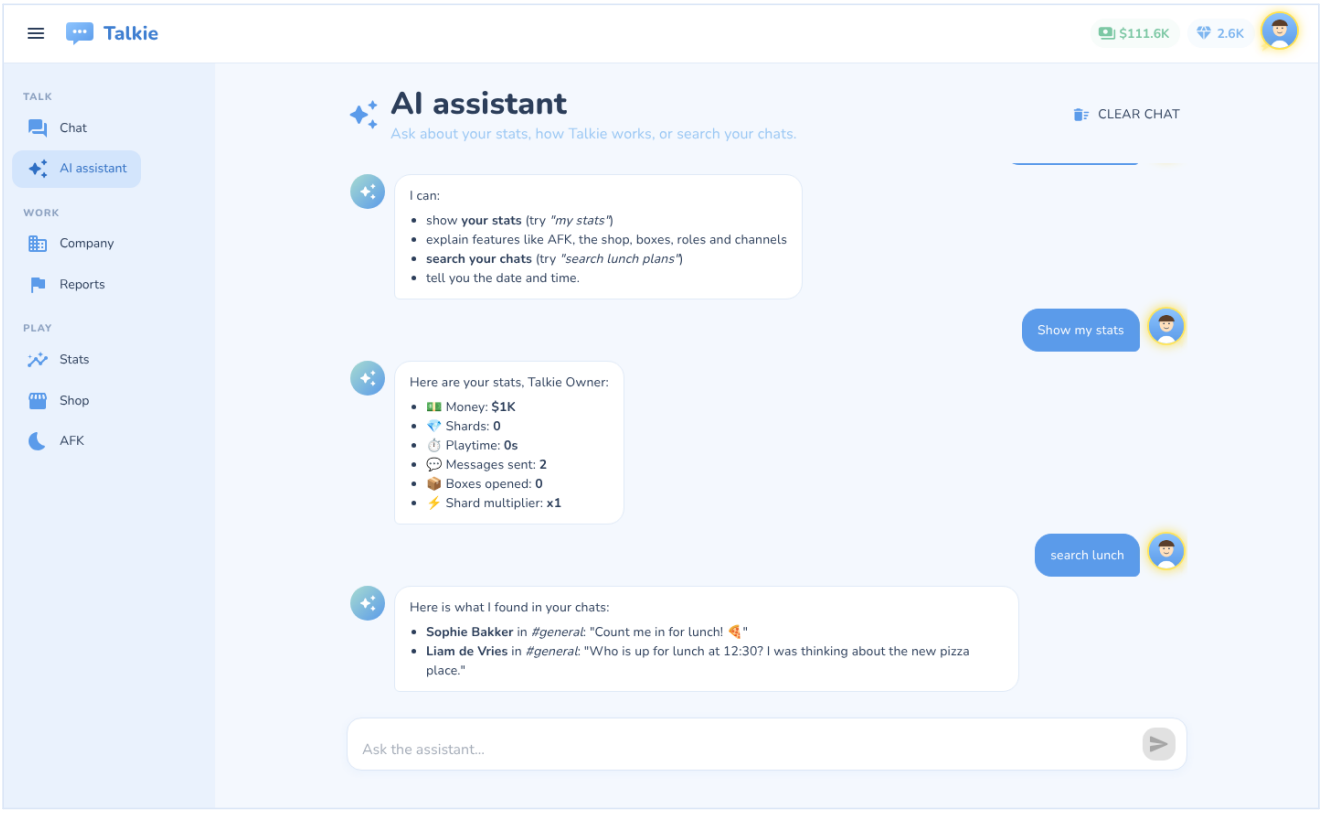


Figure 18. The AI assistant answering questions, showing stats and searching chats.

Administrators Out of the box Talkie uses a built-in offline assistant. An administrator can connect any OpenAI-compatible model (OpenAI, Azure OpenAI, Ollama, LM Studio, ...) by setting **AI:Endpoint**, **AI:Model** and **AI:ApiKey** on the API. Relevant chat messages found with vector search are then given to the model as context.

6. Company

The Company page lists all members of your company with their roles. Use the search box to filter by name, e-mail or role.

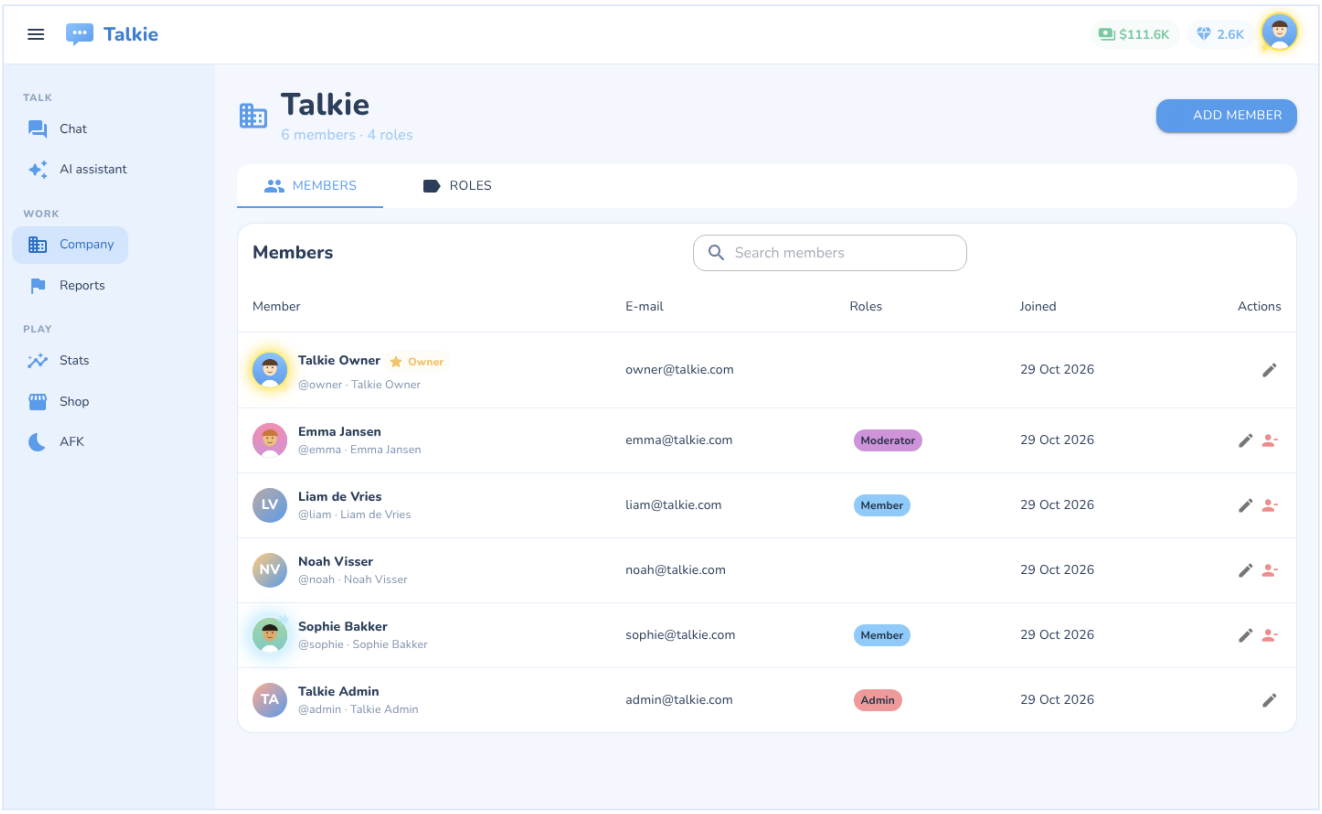


Figure 19. The members of the Talkie company.

Adding members (owner)

Click **Add member** and enter the **name**, **surname** and **e-mail**, and optionally select roles. Talkie generates a temporary password, shows it once and e-mails it to the new member.

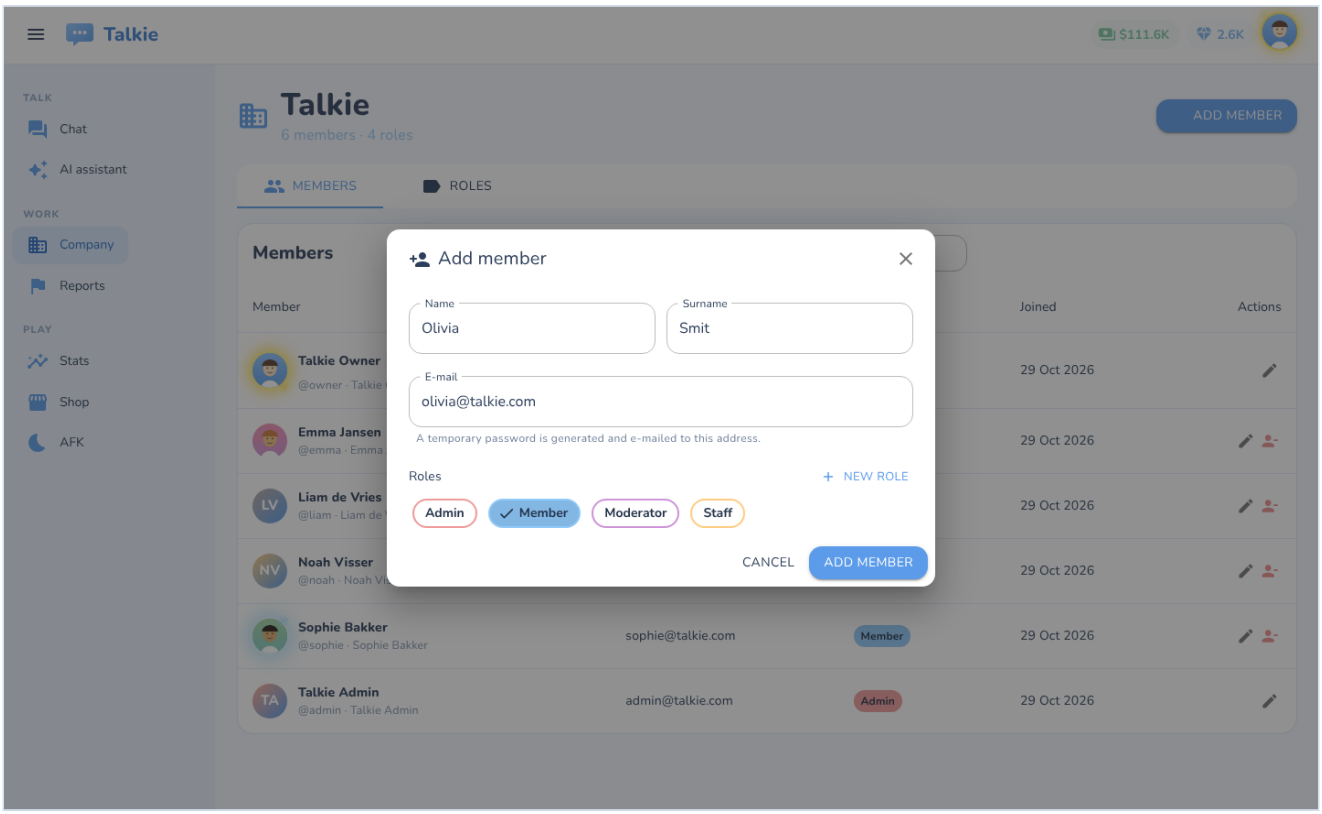


Figure 20. Adding a member.

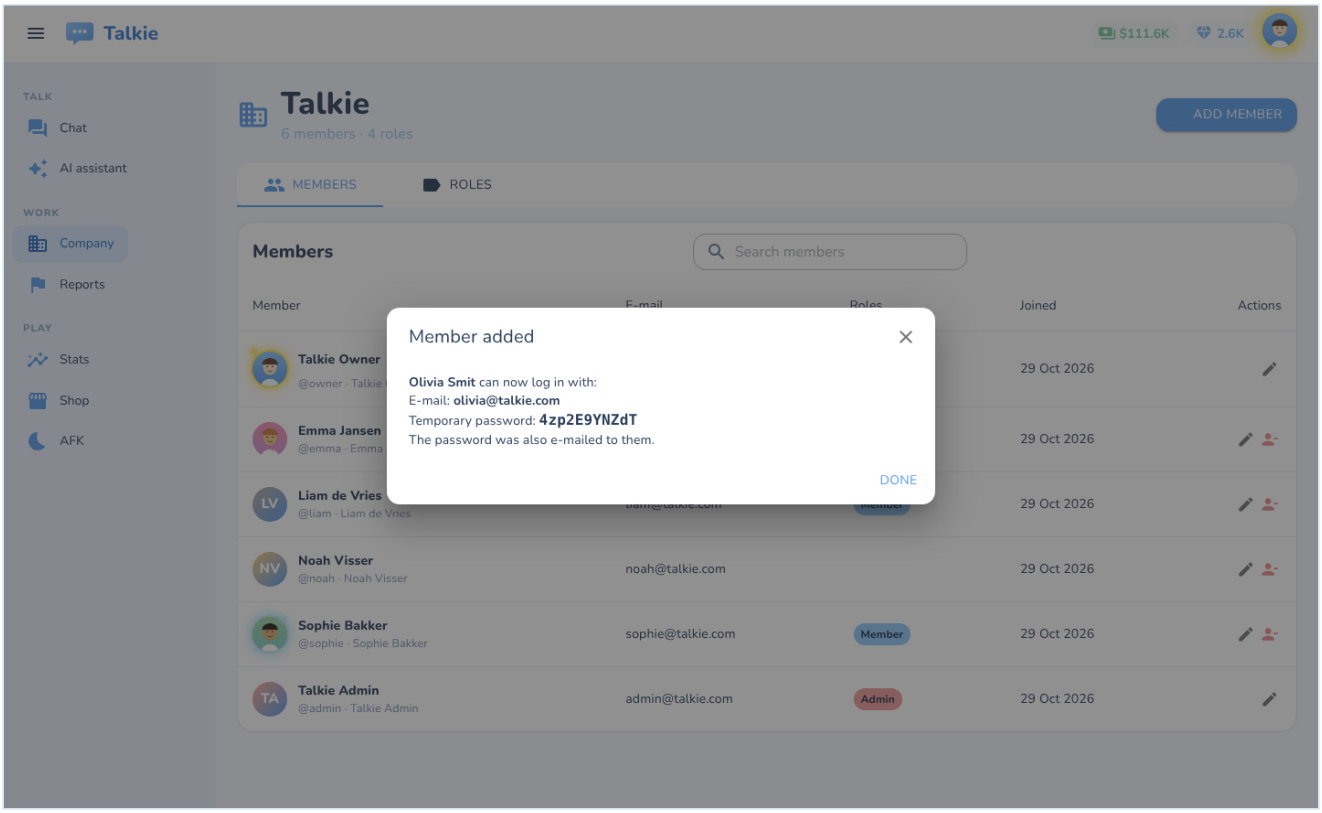


Figure 21. The temporary password is shown once and e-mailed.

Editing and deleting members (owner)

Use the pencil icon to change a member's name, display name, username and roles. Use the delete icon to remove a member. **Deleting a member also deletes their account and**

e-mail address: they are logged out immediately, their messages are removed and the e-mail can be used again. The owner and admin@talkie.com cannot be deleted.

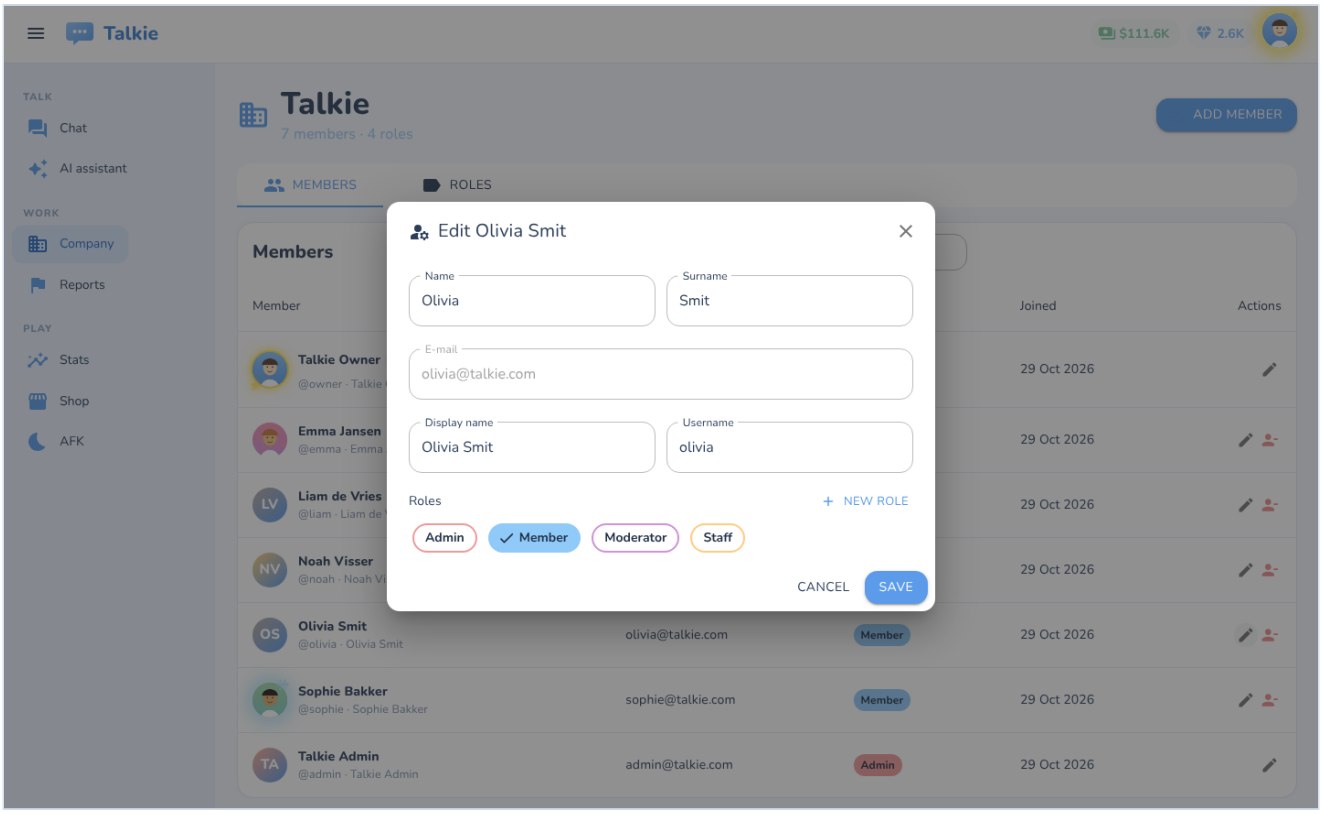


Figure 22. Editing a member and their roles.

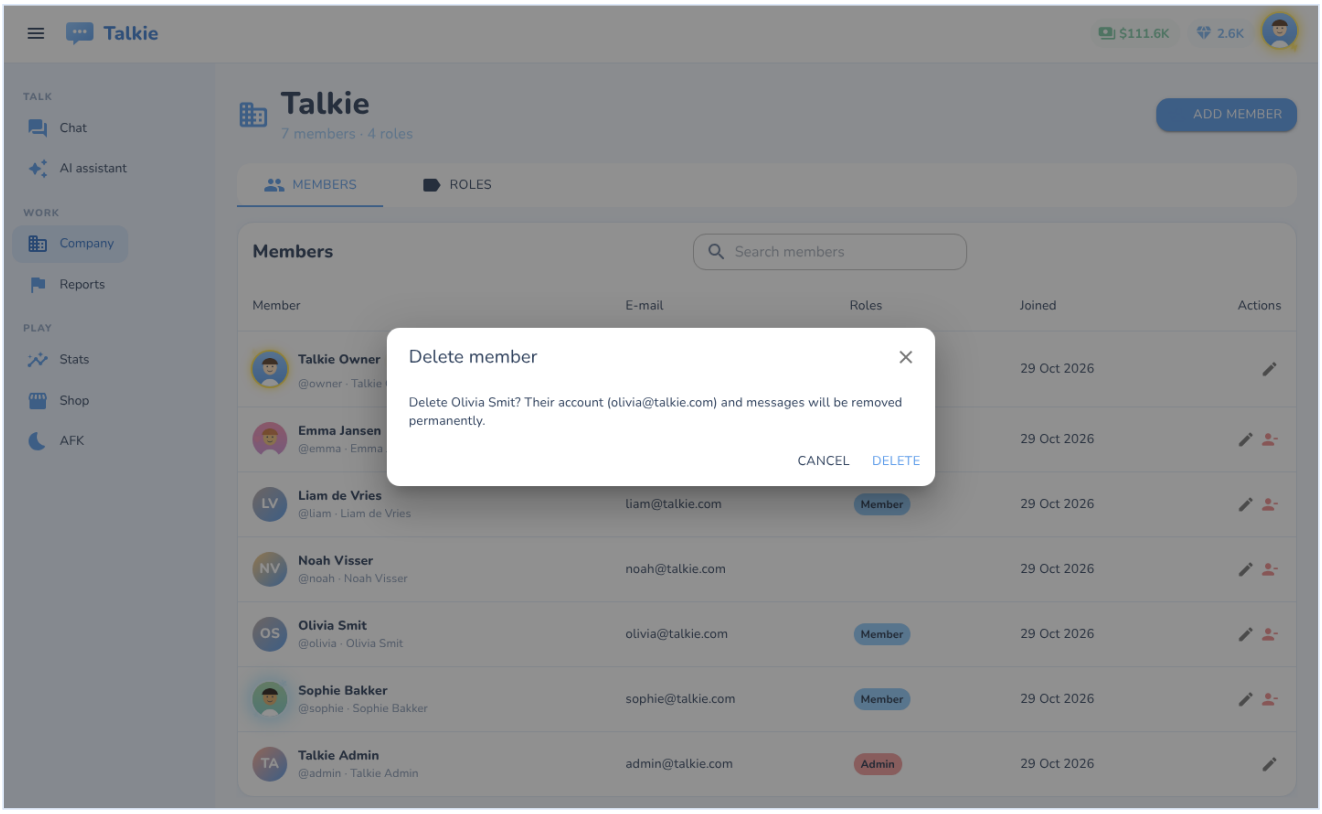


Figure 23. Deleting a member asks for confirmation.

Roles

The **Roles** tab lists all roles with their color and number of members. Owners can create, rename, recolor and delete roles.

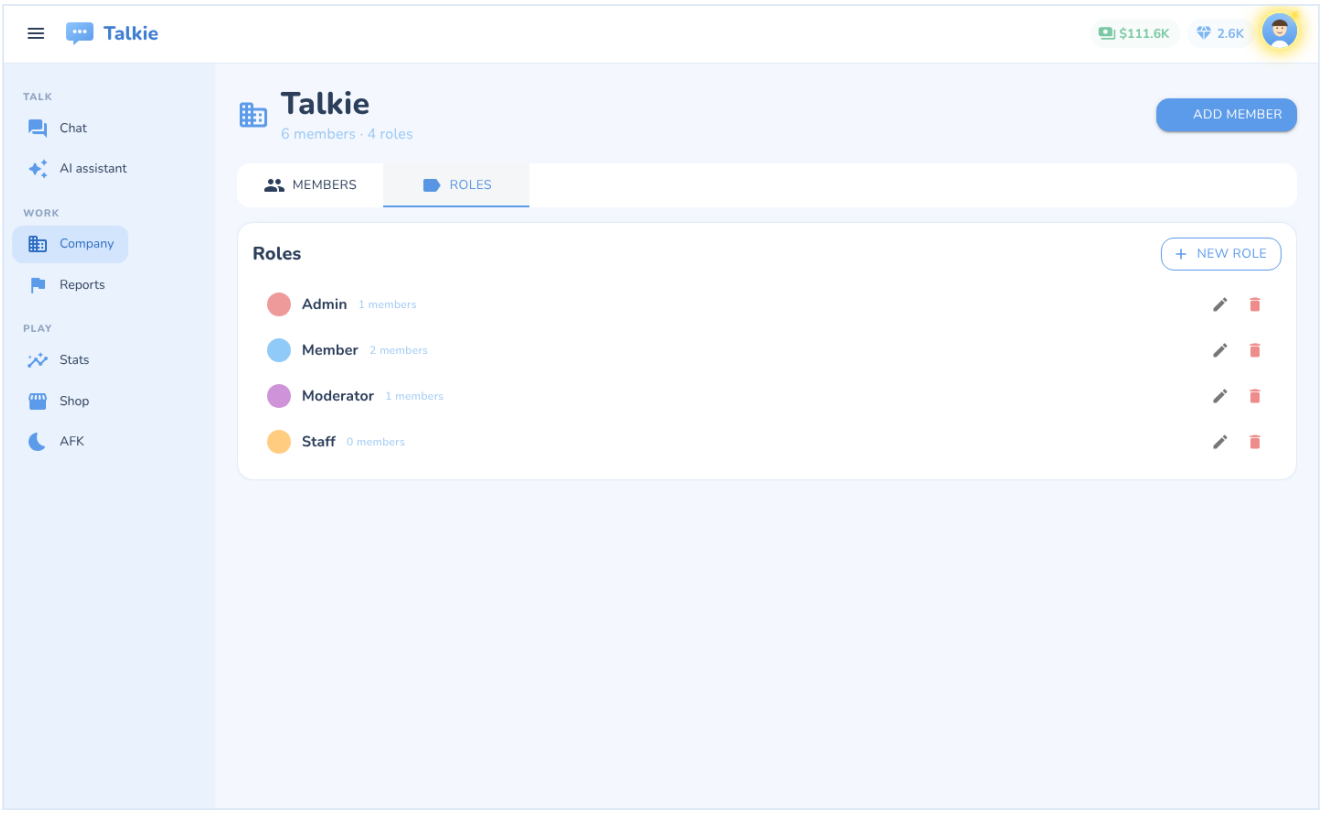


Figure 24. Managing roles.

7. Reports

Everyone can report a user: click **Report a user**, choose the user by e-mail and describe the reason. Members see the reports they sent.

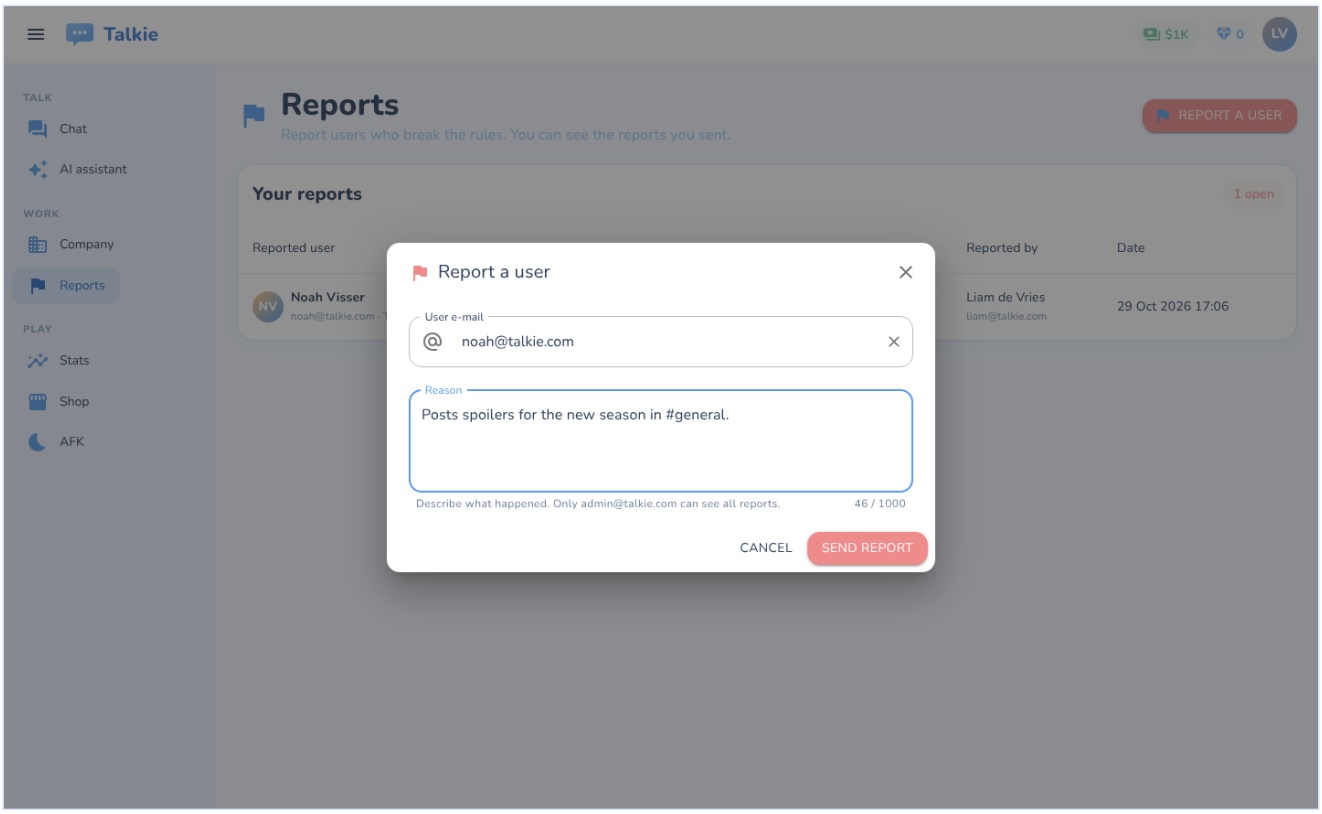


Figure 25. Reporting a user.

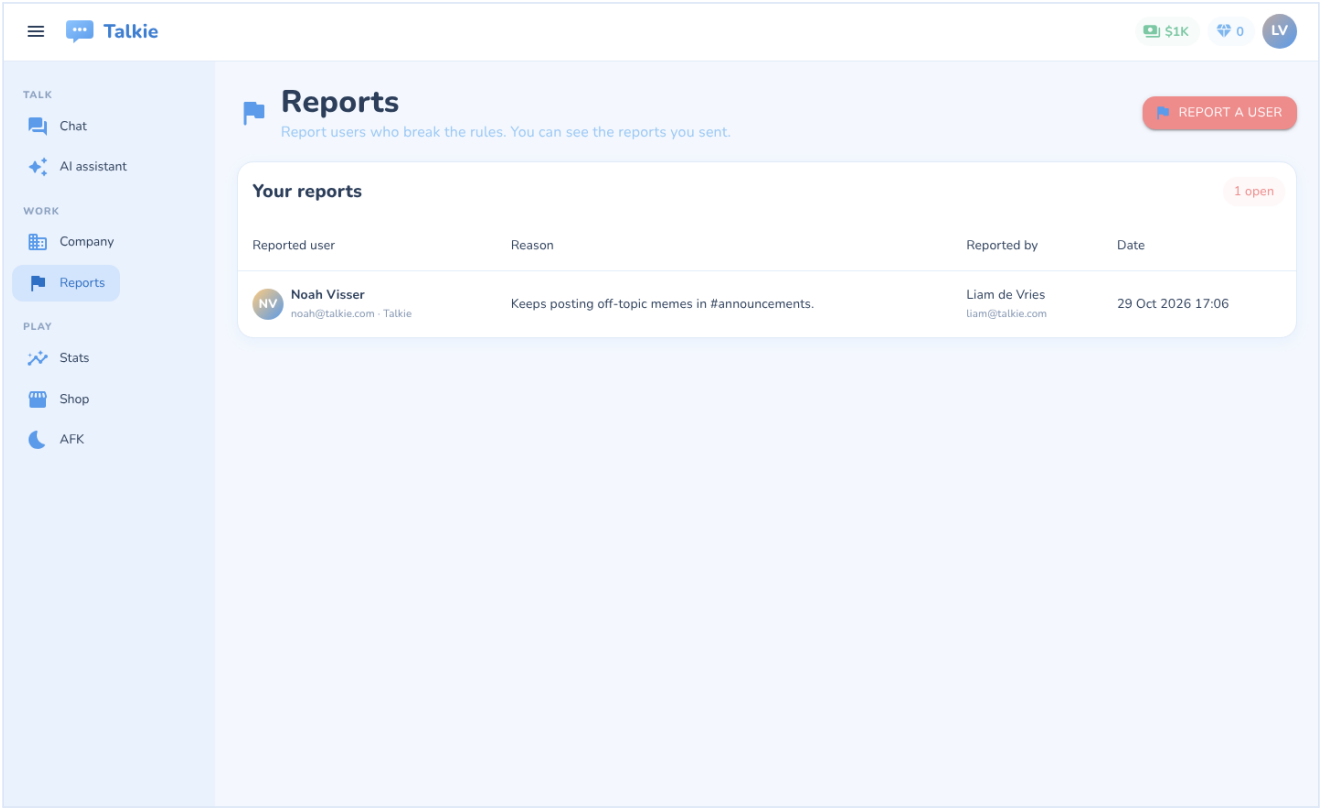


Figure 26. A member sees their own reports.

admin@talkie.com sees all reports from every company and is the only one who can remove reports, with the delete icon at the end of each row.

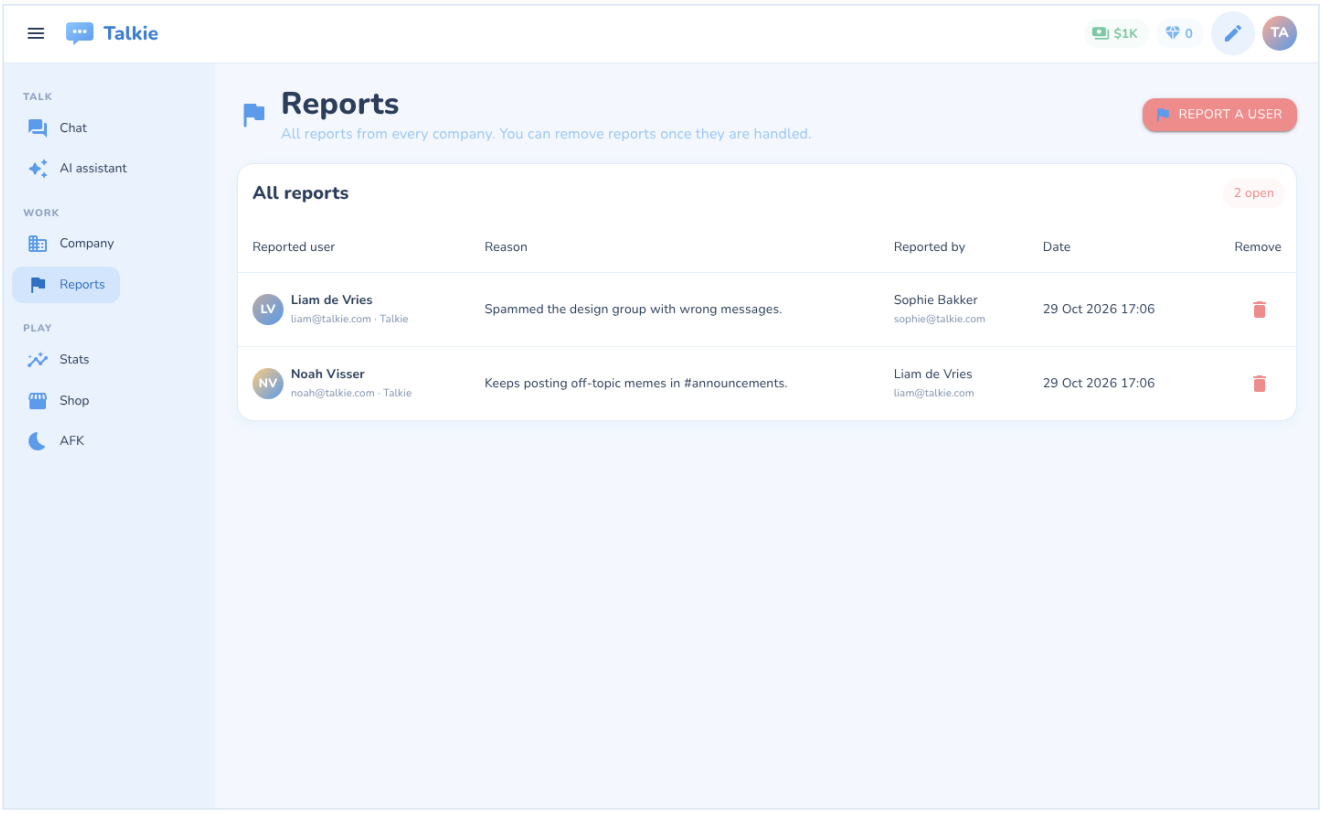


Figure 27. The admin view: all reports, with remove buttons.

8. Stats

The Stats page shows your **money**, **shards**, **playtime**, **chat messages sent** and **boxes opened**, plus a leaderboard of your company. Playtime counts how long you have had Talkie open.

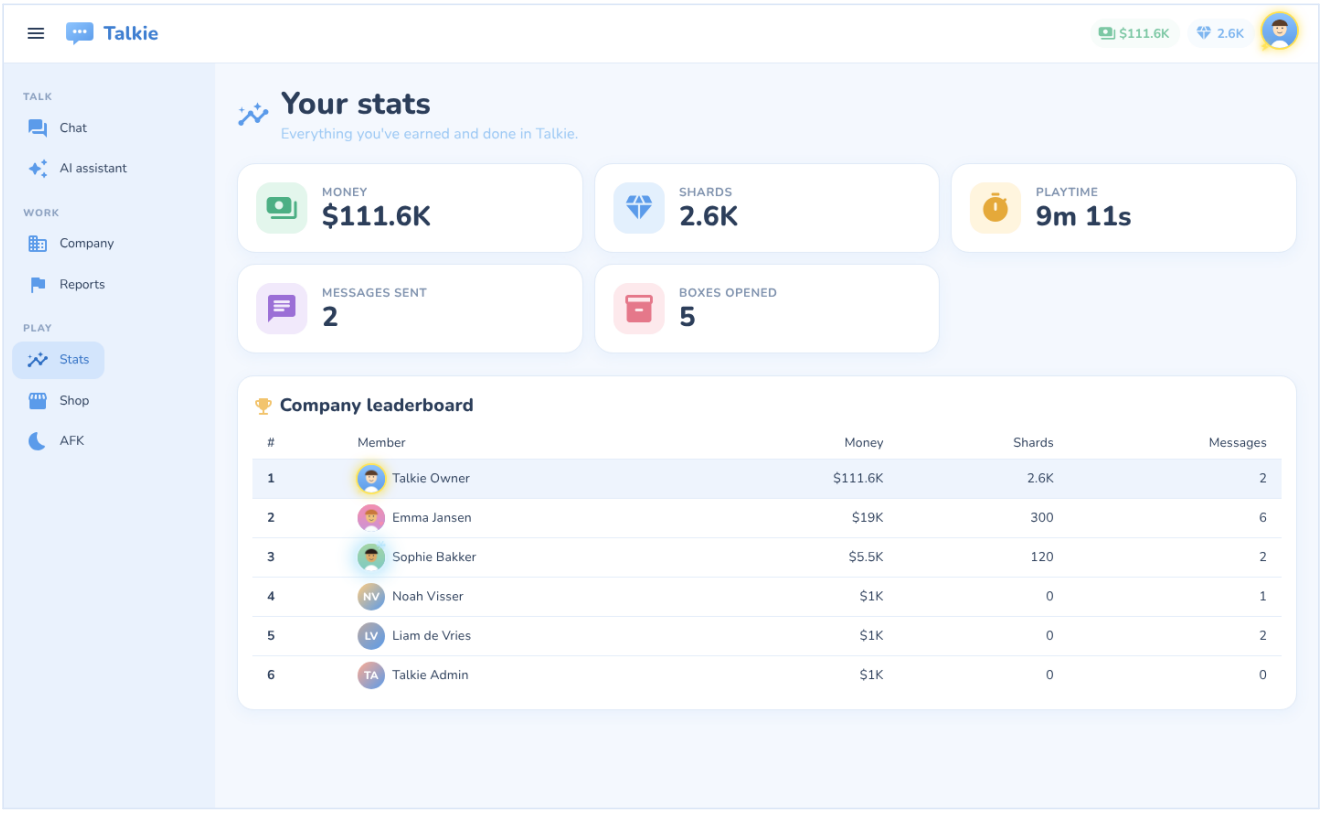


Figure 28. Your stats and the company leaderboard.

9. Shop

The shop has four tabs. Your balance is shown at the top right.

Boxes

Box	Price	Possible rewards
Common Box	$200	$100, $200, $500 or $1K
Rare Box	$500	$200, $500, $1K, $5K or $10K
Shard Box	$1K	100, 200, 500, 1K or 5K shards

Buy a box and a dialog opens: **tap the box as fast as you can!** After 10 taps it opens and shows your reward (and how fast you were). Bigger rewards are rarer. Bought boxes you have not opened yet are listed under Your unopened boxes.

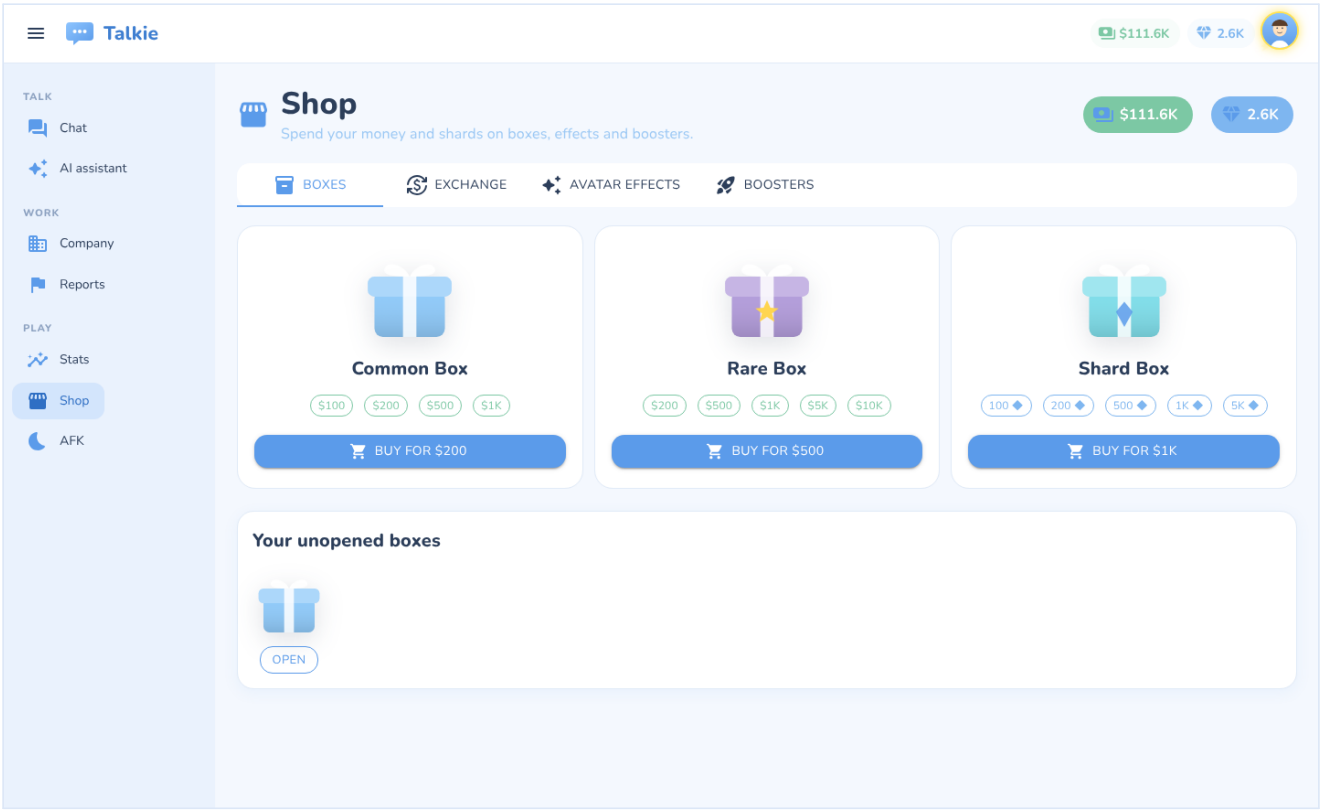


Figure 29. The three boxes.

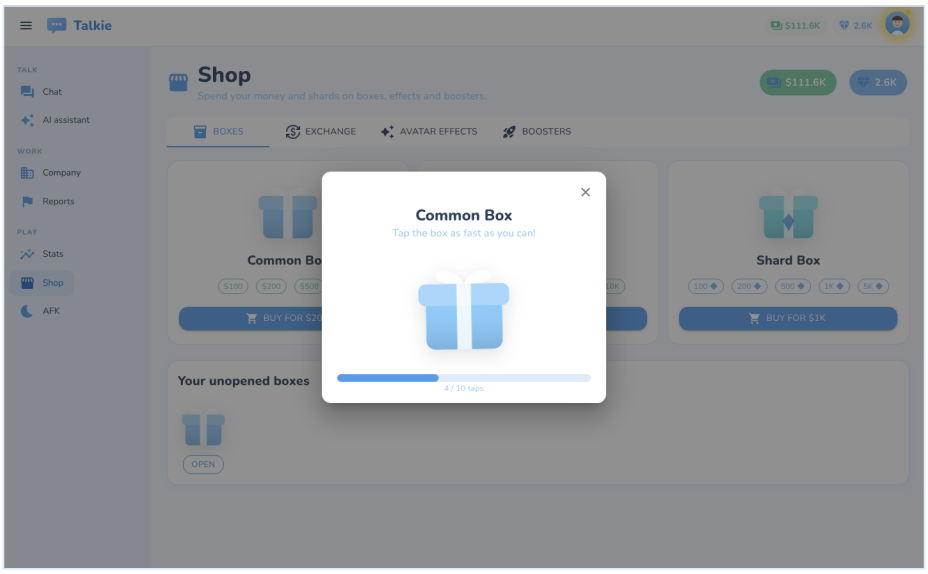


Figure 30. Tap the box to open it.

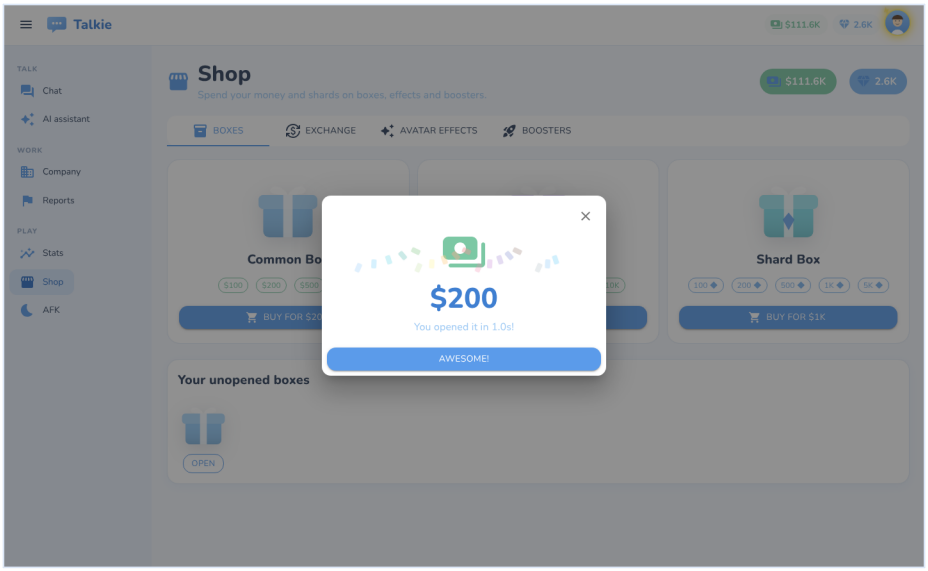


Figure 31. The reward.

Exchange

Buy shards with money, or buy money with shards. The exchange rates are set by the administrator (default: 1 shard = $10).

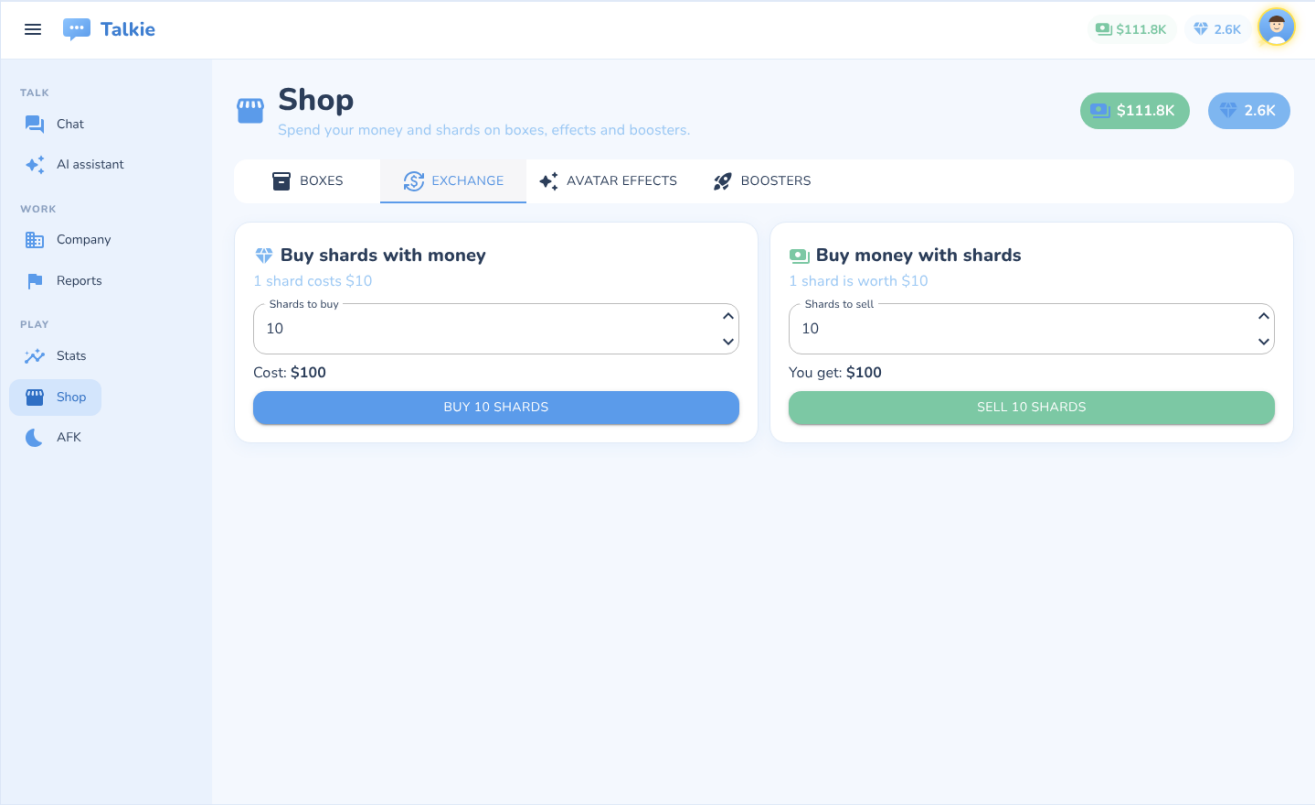


Figure 32. Exchanging money and shards.

Avatar effects

Effects decorate your avatar everywhere in Talkie - in chat, the member list and the top bar. A bought effect is equipped immediately; you own it forever and can switch or remove it at any time.

Effect	Price	Description
Energy Lightning	$2.5K	Small yellow energy bolts strike around your avatar.
Sparkles	$1.5K	Glittering stars twinkle around your avatar.
Floating Hearts	$2K	Little hearts float up from your avatar.
Frost Aura	$3.5K	A cool icy glow pulses around your avatar.
Blazing Fire	$5K	Your avatar is wrapped in a flickering flame ring.
Rainbow Halo	$7.5K	A rotating rainbow ring circles your avatar.
Galaxy Orbit	$15K	Planets orbit your avatar.

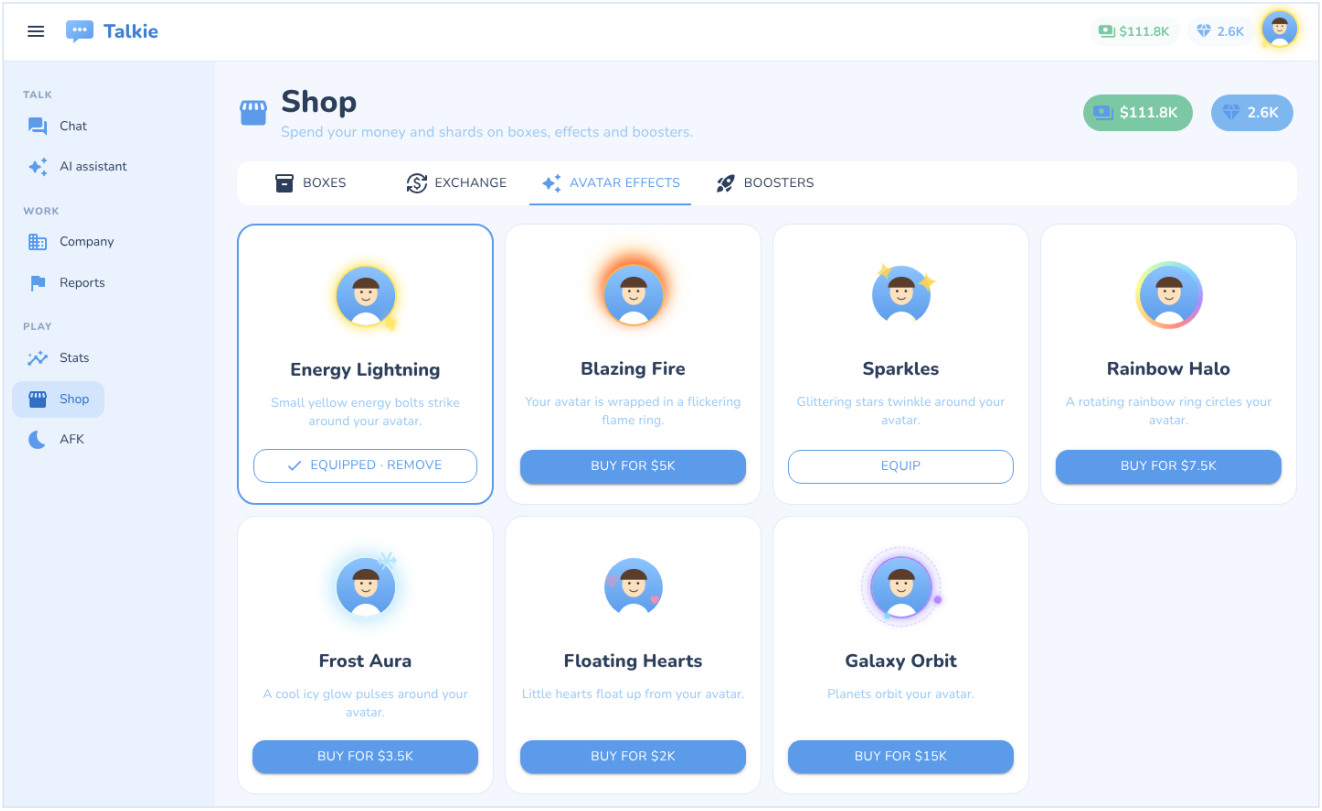


Figure 33. Avatar effects, previewed on your own avatar.

Shard boosters

Shard boosters multiply the shards you earn while AFK: **x2** ($10K) and **x4** ($50K). Boosters are permanent and the best one you own counts.

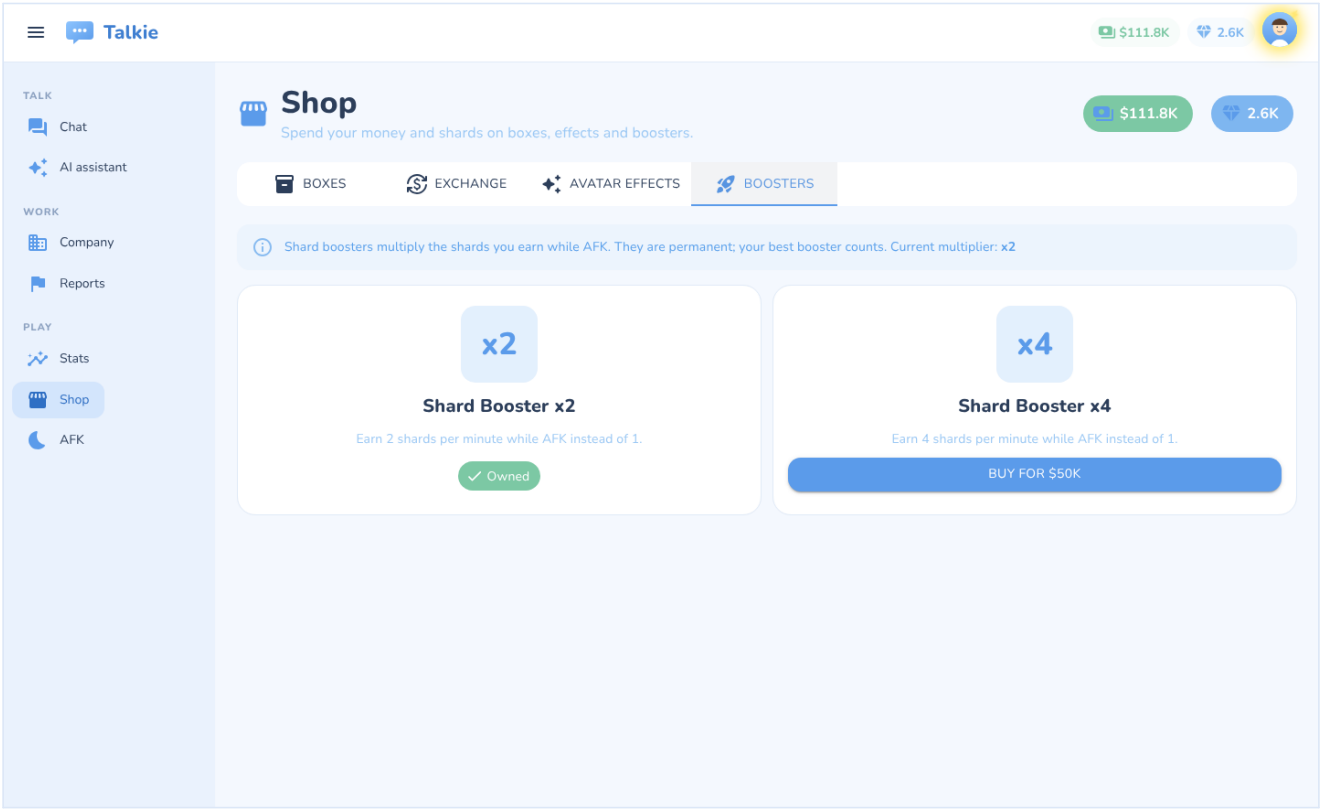


Figure 34. Shard boosters.

10. AFK

Click **Go AFK**. Talkie asks "Are you sure you want to go AFK?" - choose **Yes** or **No**. While AFK you earn **1 shard every minute** (times your booster). The page shows a timer, the shards earned in this session and a progress bar to the next shard. Click **Stop AFK** when you are back.

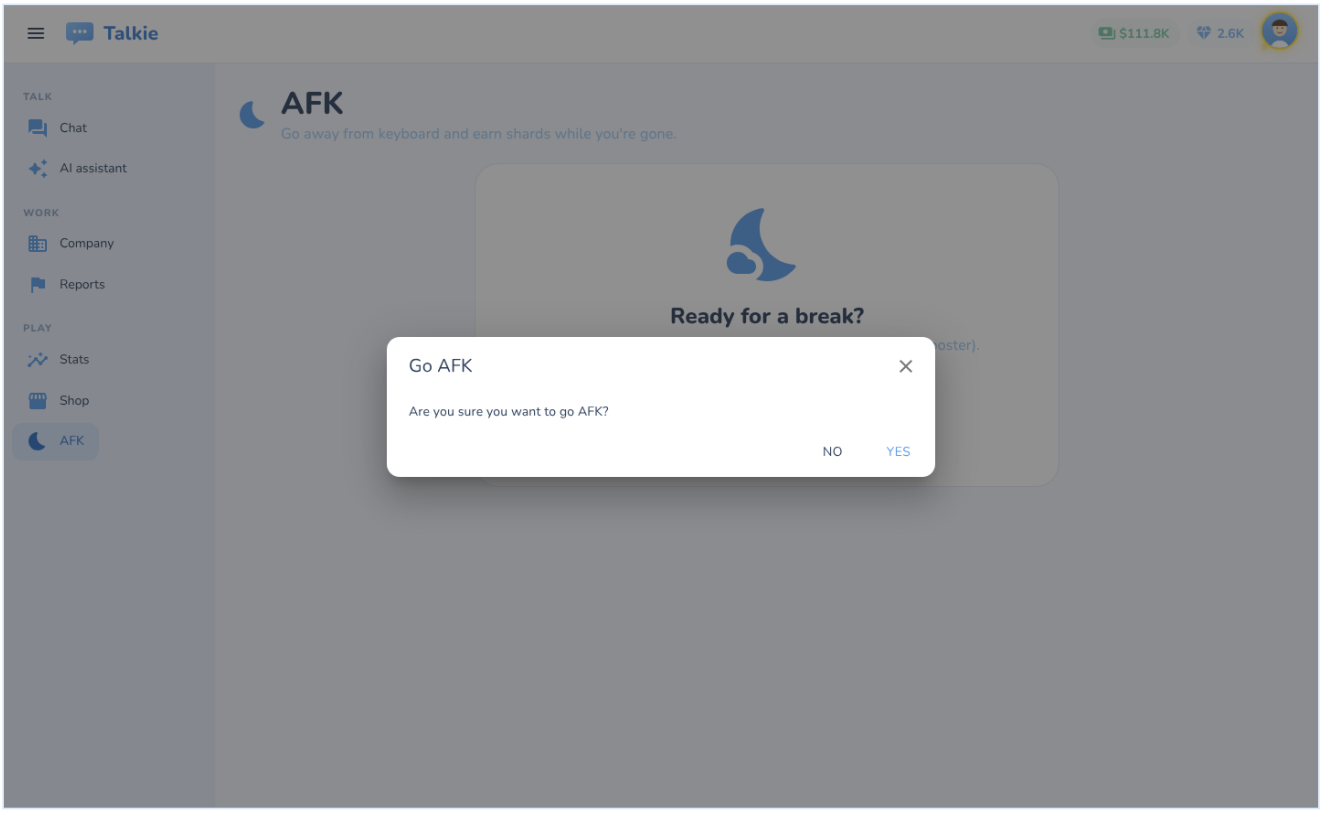


Figure 35. Confirming AFK.

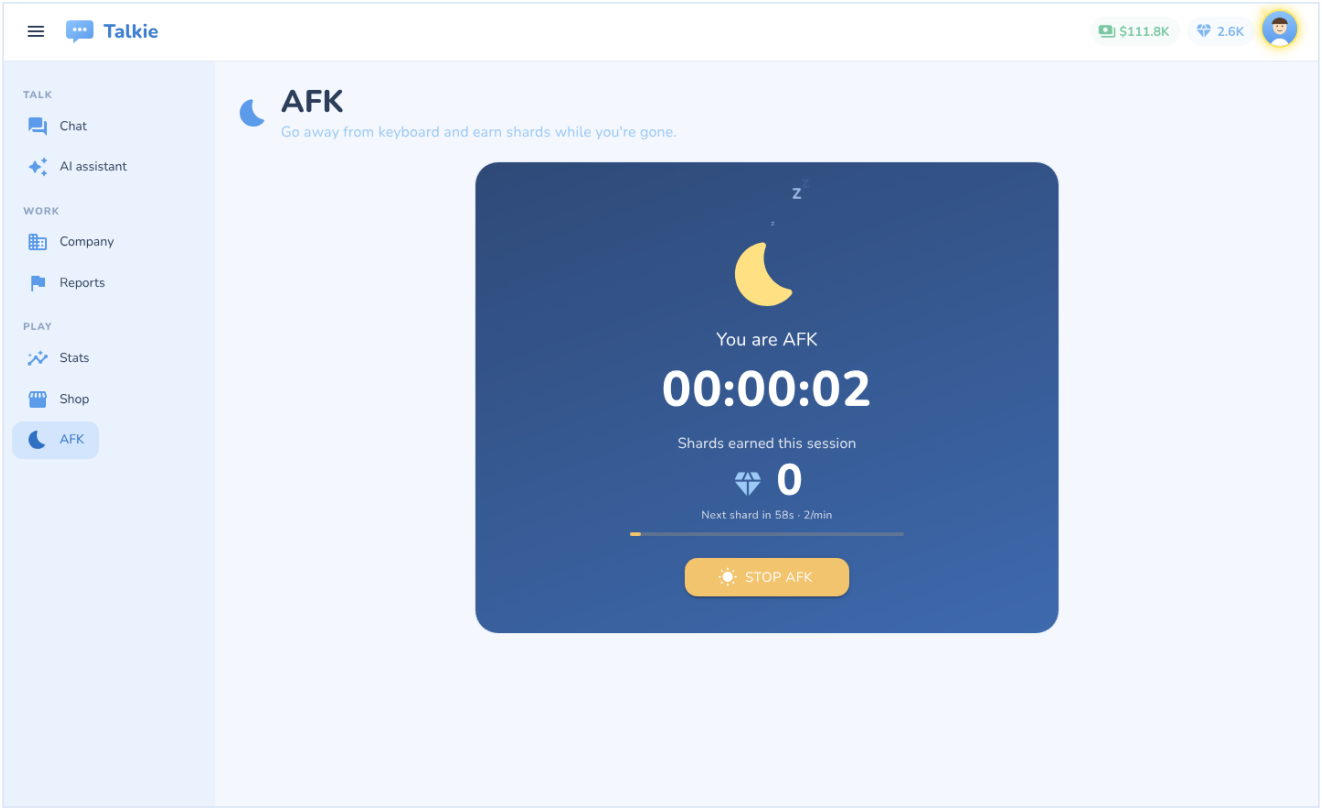


Figure 36. AFK in progress.

Tip AFK earnings are calculated on the server from timestamps, so they keep counting even if you close the browser - up to the AFK limit (24 hours by default).

11. Your account

Open **Account** from the avatar dropdown. Here you can upload a **profile picture** (PNG, JPG, GIF or WebP up to 2 MB), remove it, change your display name, username, name and surname, and change your password.

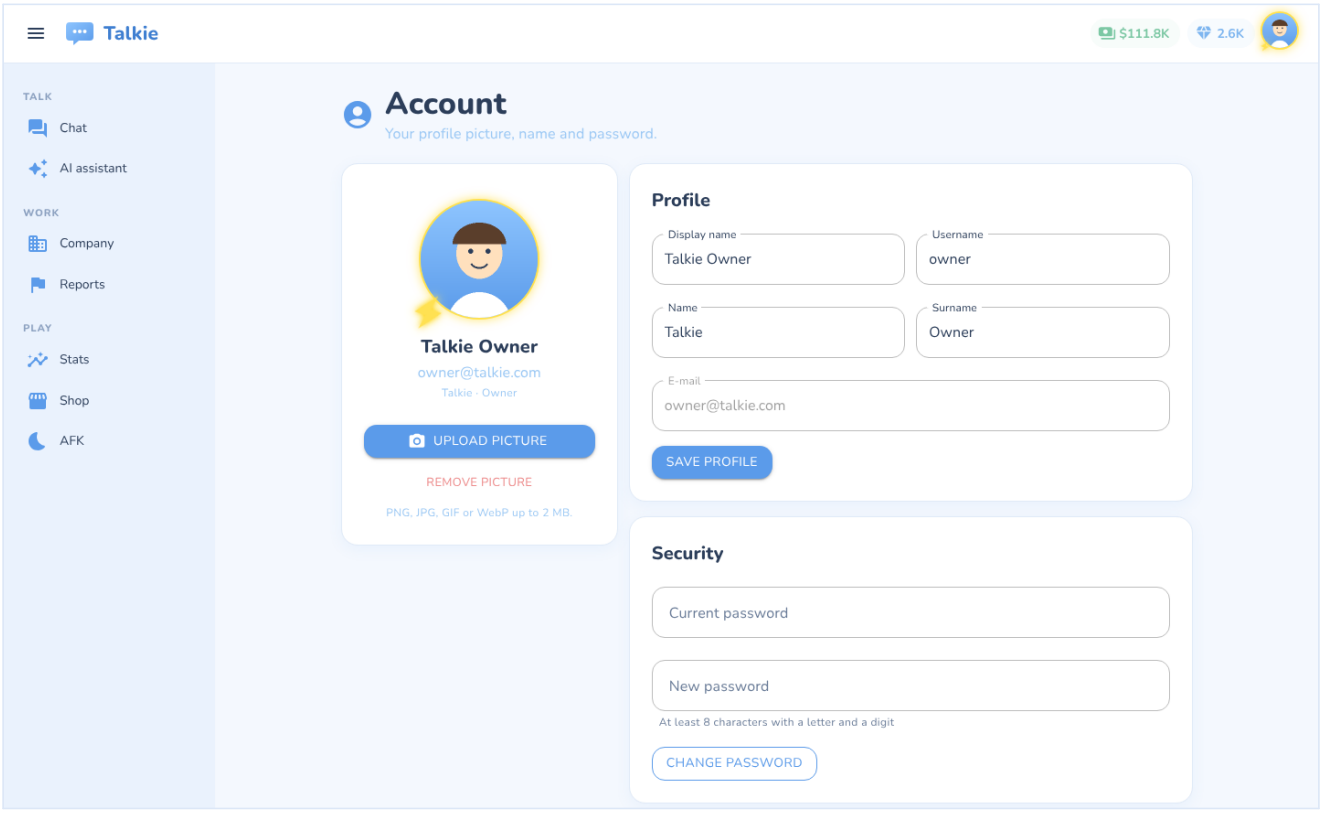


Figure 37. The account page with profile picture and the Energy Lightning effect.

12. Configuring the app (admin@talkie.com)

Log in as **admin@talkie.com** and click the **pencil button** next to your avatar. The configuration dialog has four tabs:

- **General** - the app name, an announcement banner shown to everyone (also on the login screen) and whether new companies may be created.
- **Economy** - starting money and shards for new accounts, AFK shards per minute, the AFK limit in hours, the shard exchange rates and the box prices.
- **Companies** - all companies with owner and member count. Companies (except Talkie) can be deleted with all their data.
- **Grant** - give (or take) money and shards to any user.

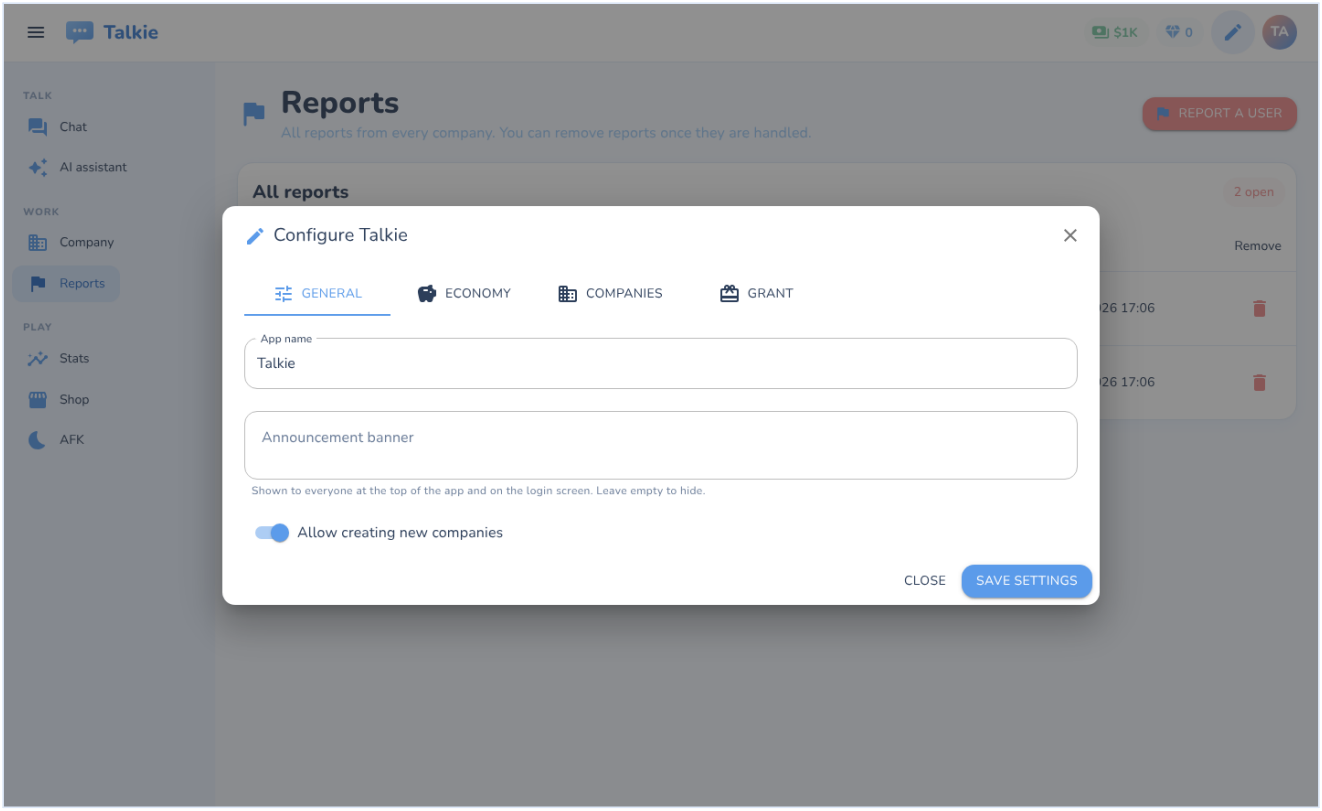


Figure 38. General settings.

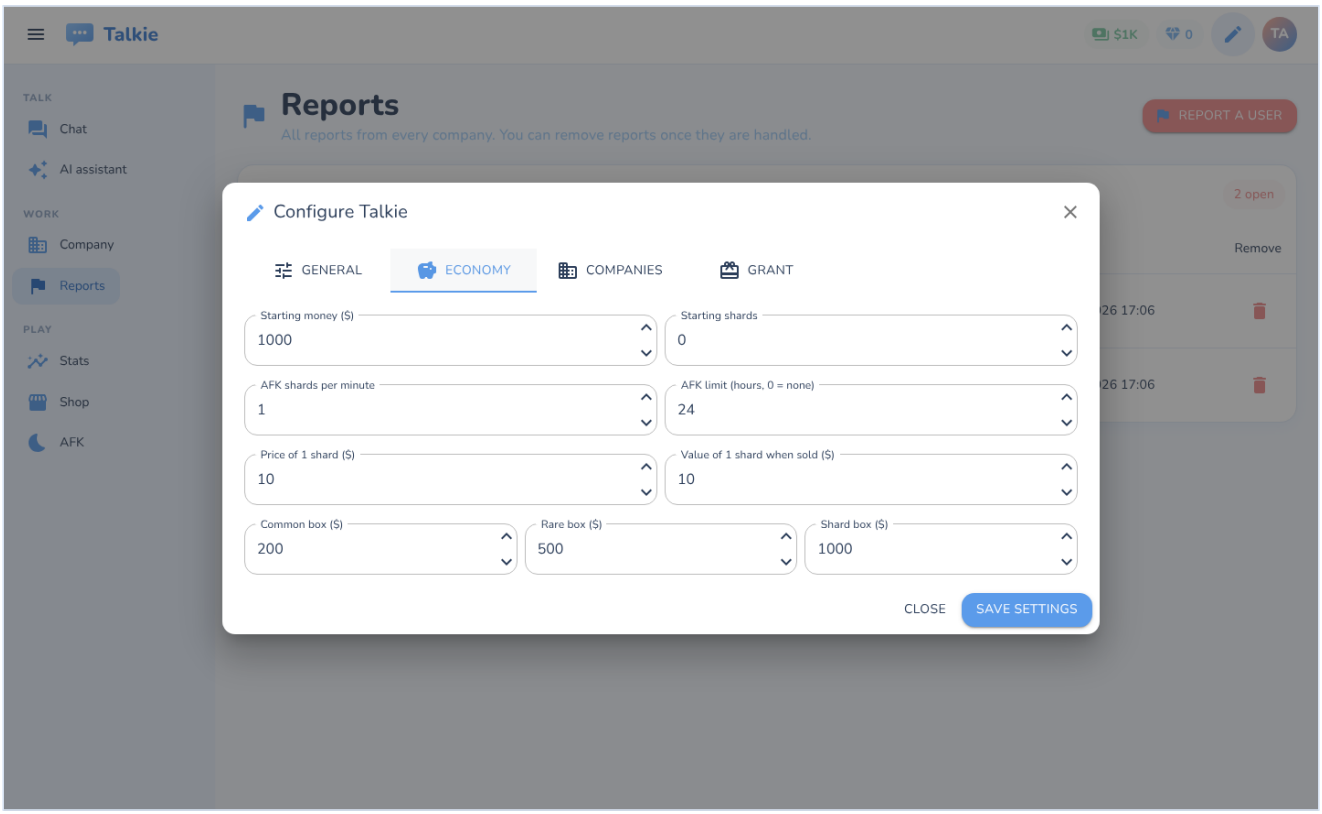


Figure 39. Economy settings.

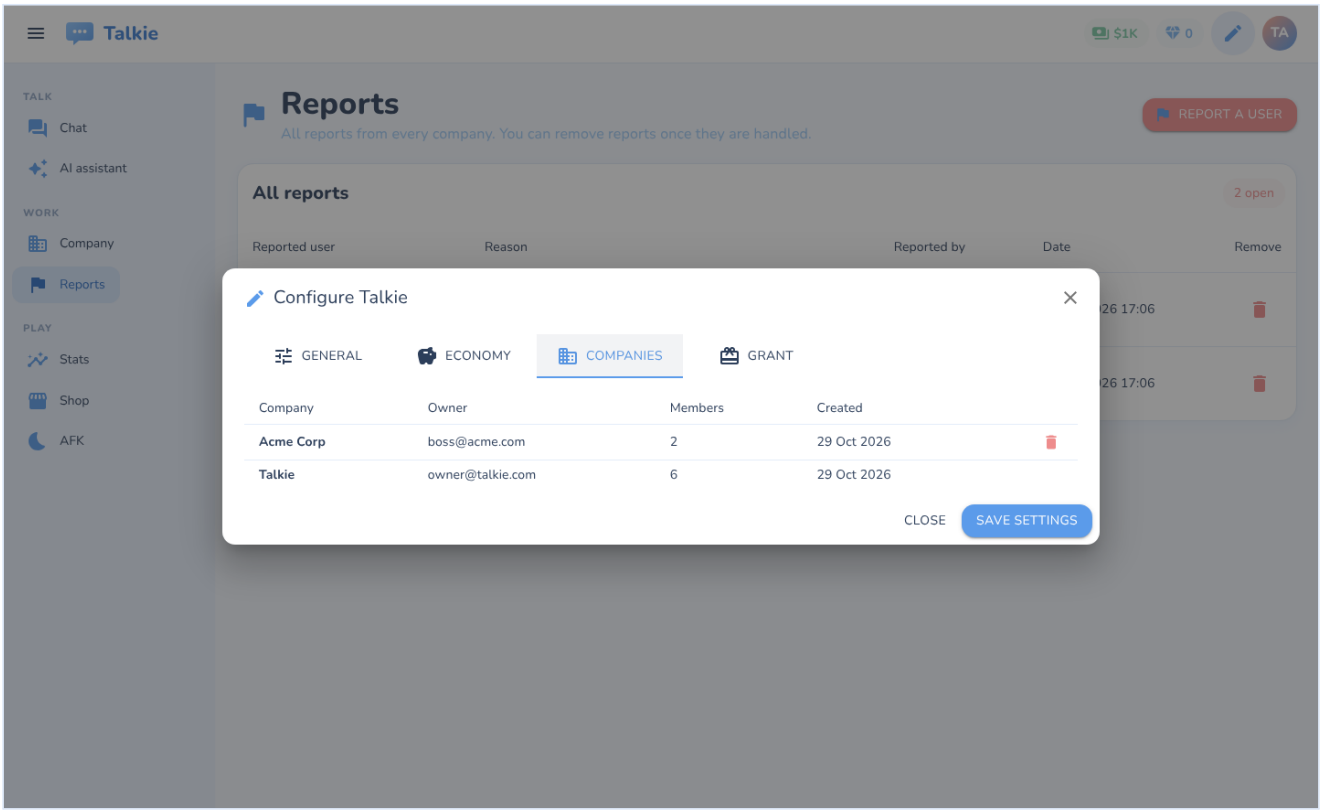


Figure 40. All companies.

13. Installing and running Talkie

Requirements

- .NET 10 SDK
- Docker (or Podman) for SQL Server 2025 and MailPit
- A modern browser

Start everything with .NET Aspire

The Aspire AppHost starts SQL Server 2025, MailPit, the migration service, the API and the web front end in the right order:

```
git clone https://github.com/tomvanoost/talkie.git
cd talkie
dotnet run --project src/Talkie.AppHost
```

Open the Aspire dashboard link printed in the console and click the URL of the **web** resource. The **migrations** resource applies the database schema and creates the built-in accounts, then shows as Finished.

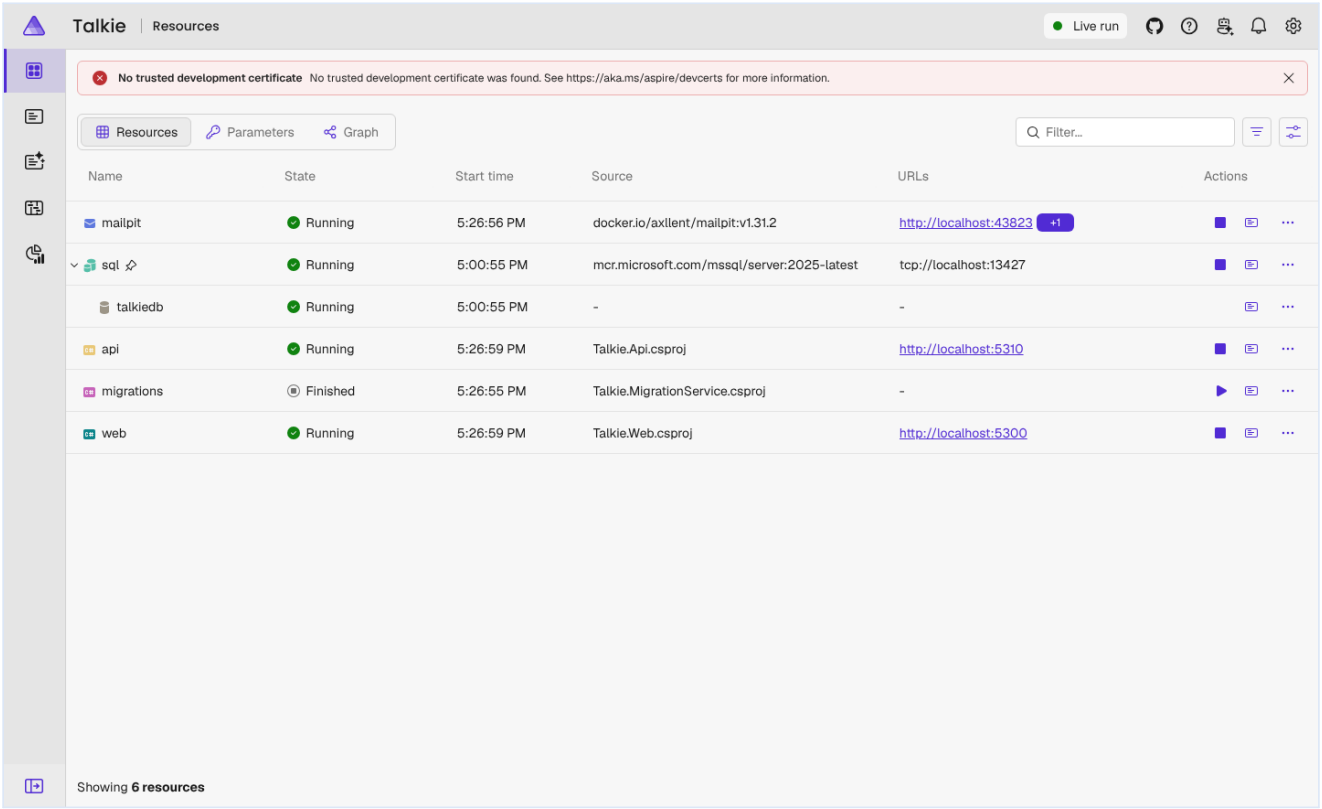


Figure 41. The Aspire dashboard with all Talkie resources.

E-mail

All e-mails (welcome mails and temporary passwords) are caught by **MailPit**. Open its URL from the dashboard to read them.

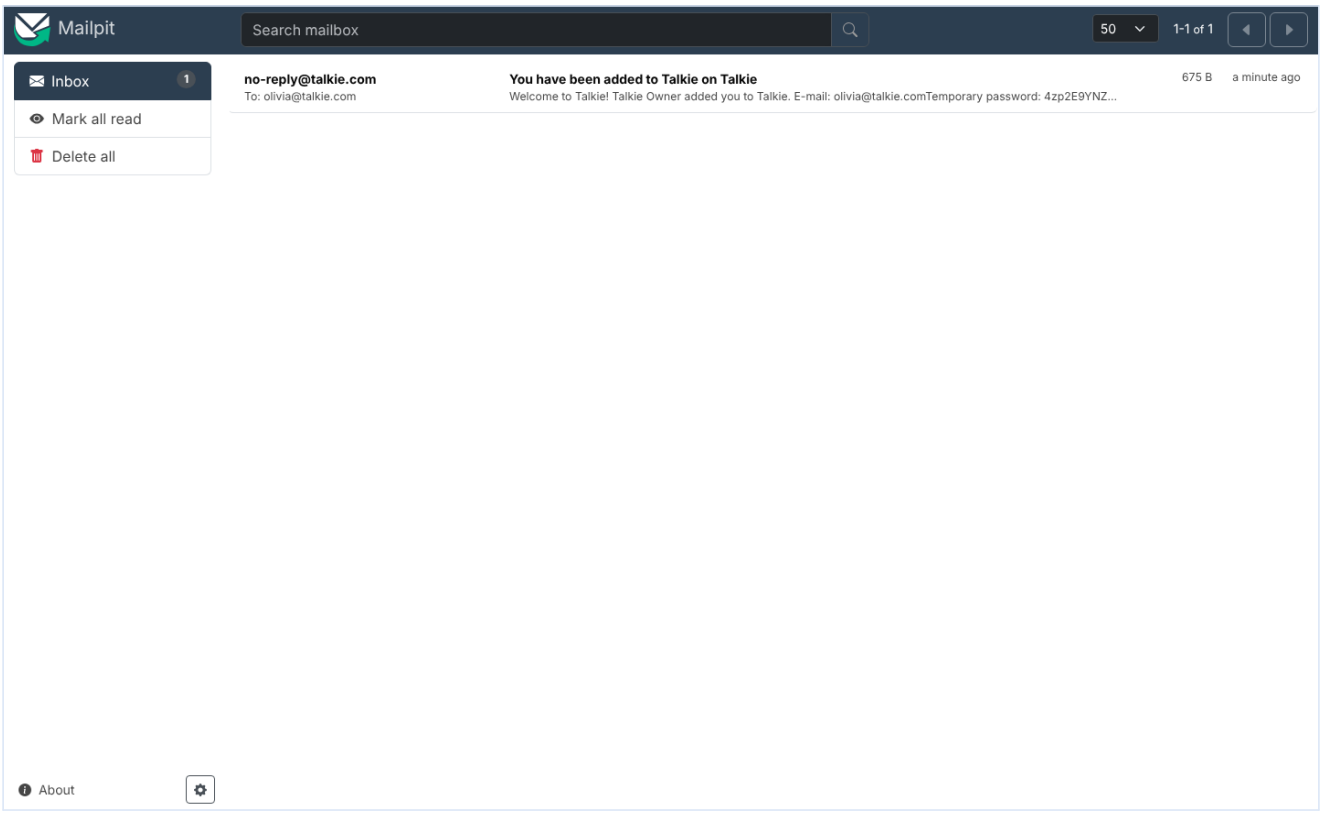


Figure 42. MailPit showing the e-mail with a temporary password.

Configuration

Setting	Where	Meaning
auth-signing-key	Aspire parameter (generated)	Key used to sign login tokens (Auth:SigningKey on the API).
admin-password	Aspire parameter	Initial password of admin@talkie.com.
Seed:OwnerPassword	Migration service	Initial password of owner@talkie.com (default fwkh837h@m1).
AI:Endpoint / AI:Model / AI:ApiKey	API	Optional OpenAI-compatible model for the AI assistant.
ConnectionStrings:talkiedb	API, migrations	Provided by Aspire; SQL Server 2025 (compatibility level 170).
ConnectionStrings:mailpit	API	Provided by Aspire; SMTP server for e-mail.

14. Architecture

Layer	Technology
Frontend	Blazor WebAssembly (.NET 10) with MudBlazor, pastel blue theme, English UI. Live updates via SignalR.
Web host	ASP.NET Core host serving the WebAssembly app and proxying /api and /hubs to the API (YARP + service discovery).
Backend	ASP.NET Core minimal APIs as a modular monolith: Auth, Company, Chat, Servers, AI, Reports, Stats, Shop, AFK and Admin modules.
Data	EF Core 10 on SQL Server 2025, including the native vector(256) column used for semantic message search with VECTOR_DISTANCE.
Hosting	.NET Aspire 13 orchestrates SQL Server, MailPit, the migration service, the API and the web front end.

Security notes: passwords are hashed with ASP.NET Core Identity's PasswordHasher; the API issues signed JWTs; every request checks that the account still exists (so deleted members are logged out immediately); balances are changed with single conditional UPDATE statements so they can never go negative; box rewards are rolled on the server.

15. Frequently asked questions

I cannot create a company called Talkie.

Talkie is the built-in company; the name is reserved.

I don't see the + next to Text channels.

Only the company owner (and admin@talkie.com in the Talkie company) can create channels.

I cannot type in a channel.

None of your roles has the Send messages permission there. Ask the company owner.

A member forgot their password.

Delete and re-add the member to send a new temporary password, or have them use their last password.

Do I keep earning shards when I close the browser while AFK?

Yes, up to the AFK limit set by the administrator (24 hours by default).

Where is the pencil button?

It is only shown to admin@talkie.com, next to the avatar in the top bar.